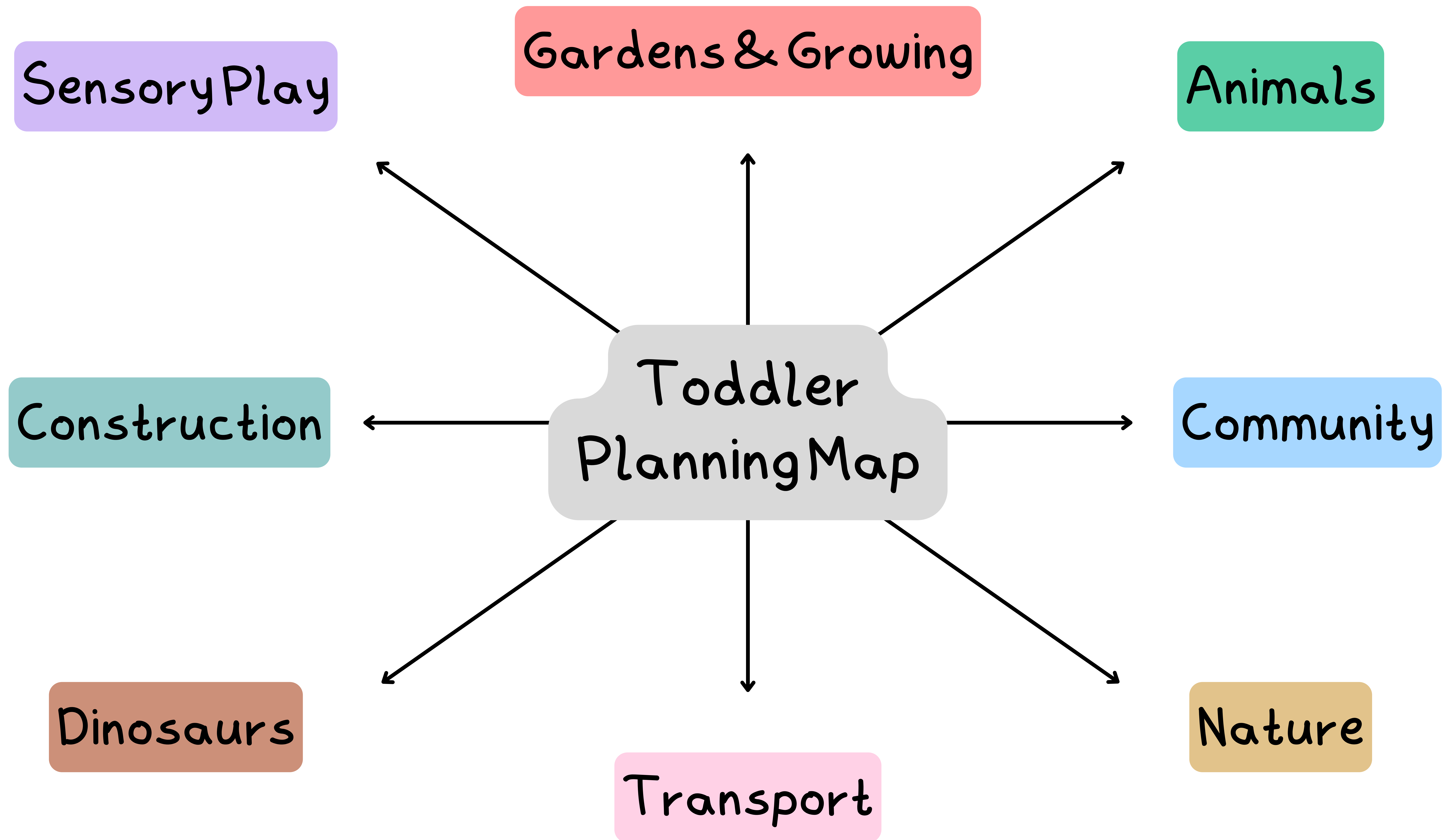
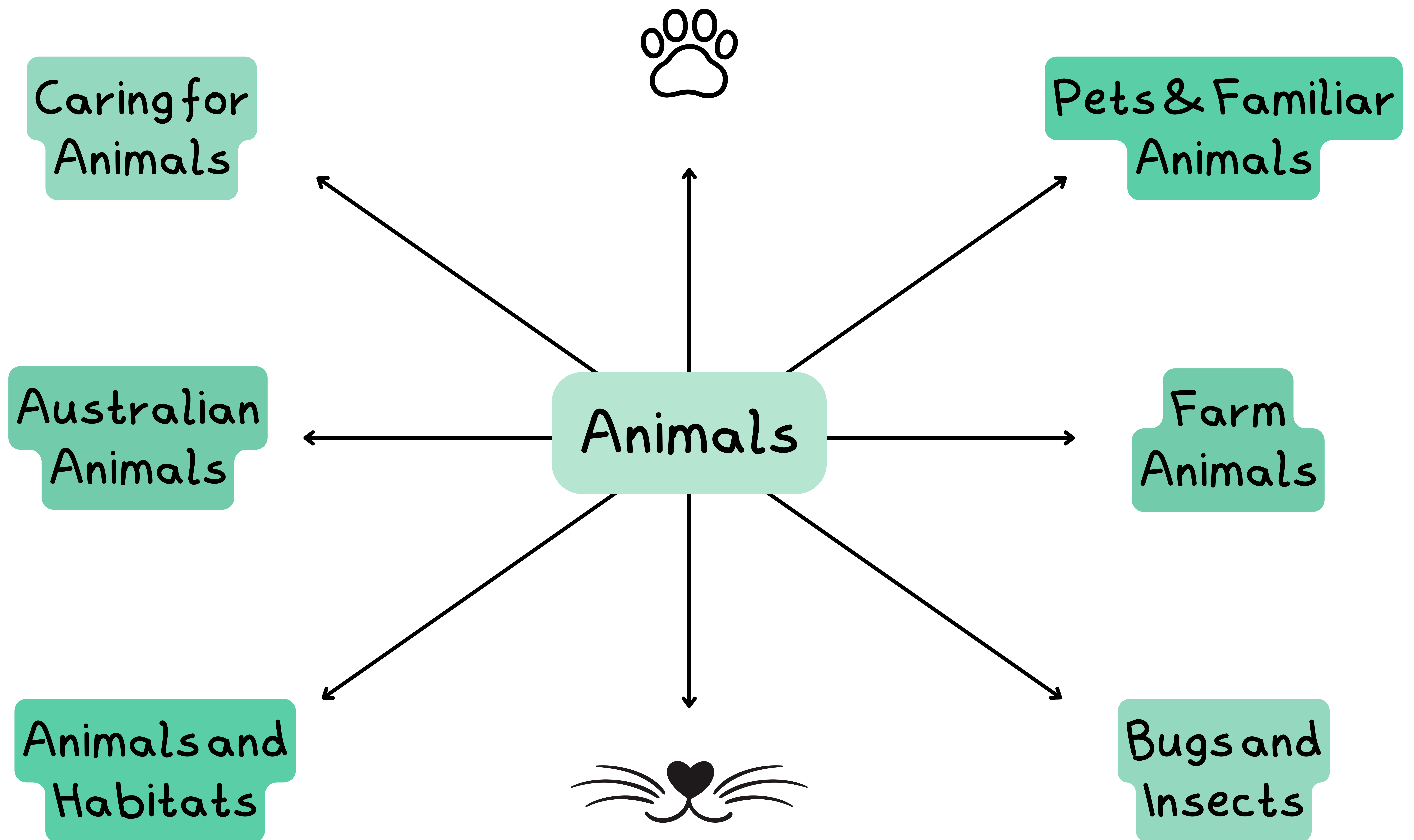






Animals – Pets & Familiar Animals

Focus of Learning	Use this page when children are:	Next Steps / Extension Ideas:
Toddlers explore animals they are familiar with through play, movement, creativity and shared experiences. By engaging with pets and helper animals they recognise from everyday life, children build understanding through pretend play, sensory experiences, games and communication.	• Talking about pets or animals at home • Showing interest in animals seen in books or the community • Engaging in pretend play • Enjoying movement, drawing or animal games	

Domain	Activity Ideas
Communication & Language	• Pet Photo Wall – Create a wall display using photos of pets or familiar animals. Families are invited to send photos via email or bring printed images. Toddlers can visit the wall throughout the day, returning to images and making connections during play. <i>EYLF: LO5.1, LO5.2</i> • Pet Stories – Share a range of books that feature pets and familiar animals during group times. Books are available in reading areas and can be revisited across the day and week. <i>EYLF: LO5.1, LO5.2</i> ◦ <i>Spot Goes to the Farm, Hairy Maclary from Donaldson’s Dairy, My Puppy</i>
Dramatic Play	• Pet Care Play – Provide toy animals, bowls, brushes, beds and simple props for pretend caring play such as feeding, resting or visiting the vet. Provide a “vet-check-list” (picture cards for eyes, ears, paws). Children choose a card and decide what to check, turning the play into a low-stakes problem-solving task.. <i>EYLF: LO1.1, LO1.3</i>
Sensory and Nature Play	• Wash the Pets – Offer water, cloths and toy animals for wiping, washing and repeated sensory exploration, with children controlling the pace and repetition. Activity can include pet grooming videos or posters displayed in the pet wash station. <i>EYLF: LO3.1, LO4.2</i>
Creative Play	• Pet Collage & Drawing – Provide paper, collage materials and drawing tools for children to create pets or familiar animals, using the photo wall or posters as optional reference. <i>EYLF: LO4.1, LO5.3</i> • Build a Pet Space – Use blocks, boxes or loose parts to create spaces for animals such as beds, houses or yards, with children deciding how animals use the space. <i>EYLF: LO4.1, LO2.2</i>
Music and Movement	• Animal Tempo Play – Play music with clear changes in tempo. Invite children to move their bodies like a fast animal when the music is fast and a slow animal when the music is slow. Change between fast and slow to support repeated movement and awareness of pace. <i>EYLF: LO3.2, LO5.1</i>

Animals – Farm Animals

Focus of Learning	Use this page when children are:	Next Steps / Extension Ideas:
Toddlers explore farm animals through play with materials, construction, movement and shared experiences. Farm animals provide a context for noticing how animals, materials and food come from the land and are part of everyday environments.	• Showing interest in farm animals or animals seen in books, play or the environment • Engaging with animal figures or animal play • Noticing animals in stories, images or conversations • Returning to farm animal play across the day	

Domain	Activity Ideas
Creative Play	• Design a Farm – Provide blocks, boxes, fabric and loose parts with farm animals. Children build and rebuild farm spaces such as yards, shelters or sleeping areas in their own way. Mix natural and recycled materials (fabric scraps for hay, foil for water) so children experience sustainability while building. <i>EYLF: LO4.1, LO2.2</i> • Farm Animal Mark Making – Offer paper, collage materials and drawing tools with optional farm animal images nearby. Children draw, stamp or collage animals or farm spaces freely. <i>EYLF: LO4.1, LO5.3</i>
Cognitive Play	• Farm Habitat Sorting Mats – Place habitat sorting mats with a mixed set of animals. Children freely place, move and revisit animals on the mats throughout the day. <i>EYLF: LO4.1</i> • Where Food Comes From – Provide real or pretend items linked to farms (eggs, milk containers, corn, wool). Children explore and connect items to animals through play. <i>EYLF: LO2.4, LO4.2</i>
Dramatic Play	• Farm Animal Role Play – Set up simple props such as bowls, baskets, fences or beds. Children engage in pretend play including feeding animals, resting them or moving them between spaces. <i>EYLF: LO1.1, LO1.3</i> • Farm Animal Shelters – Add a weather-board (sun, rain, wind symbols) that children can move to affect the farm (e.g., “rain → animals need shelter”). Encourages discussion of how weather influences animal care. <i>LO2.4, LO4.2.</i>
Sensory and Nature Play	• Farm Sensory Tray – Provide straw, grain, fabric, scoops and farm animals in a tray or tub. Children fill, pour, bury and uncover animals through repeated sensory play. <i>EYLF: LO3.1, LO4.2</i> • Outdoor Farm Play – Take farm animals outdoors with trays, dirt, grass or sand. Children integrate animals into outdoor play, building and exploring naturally. <i>EYLF: LO2.4, LO3.1</i>
Communication and Language	• Farm Animal Books – Invite interested children to read farm animal books at group time. Children are welcome to ask questions, and can apply book context throughout inquiry. Books can remain accessible for children to revisit independently or with educators. <i>EYLF: LO5.1, LO5.2</i> • Traditional Animal Knowledge – Talk about how Aboriginal people have long understood animal behaviours, seasonal movements, and how to find animals on Country. They knew when animals would be plentiful and how to track them. <i>EYLF: LO2.4, LO4.2</i>

Animals – Bugs and Insects

Focus of Learning	Use this page when children are:	Next Steps / Extension Ideas:
Toddlers explore bugs through close observation, sensory experiences, creative play and movement. Bugs provide a meaningful context for noticing small details, exploring natural environments and engaging with animals commonly found in children’s everyday surroundings.	• Noticing bugs outdoors or in the environment • Showing curiosity about small animals • Exploring nature areas, gardens or outdoor spaces • Engaging in careful observation and repeated play	

Domain	Activity Ideas
Sensory and Nature Play	• Bug Exploration Tray – Provide toy bugs with natural materials such as leaves, bark, soil or sand. Add a magnifying glass and a “bug-lookup” card with simple pictures of the bugs in the tray; children are invited to match the bug to the image, supporting early classification. <i>EYLF: LO3.1</i> • Outdoor Bug Searching – Invite children to look for bugs during outdoor play using bug viewers or simply watching carefully near gardens, grass or logs. <i>EYLF: LO2.4, LO4.2</i> • Bug Pathways in Nature – Use sticks, stones or natural markings outdoors to create simple paths where children move bugs along the ground or through sand and dirt. <i>EYLF: LO3.1, LO4.2</i>
Creative Play	• Design a Bug – Provide drawing tools, collage materials or loose parts for children to create bugs in their own way, without expectation of realism. <i>EYLF: LO4.1, LO5.3</i> • Bug Homes – Provide children with blocks, leaves, fabric or loose parts to build spaces where bugs might hide, rest or move through. <i>EYLF: LO4.1, LO2.2</i>
Dramatic Play	• Be a Bug – Provide fabric wings, antennae headbands, or simple props. Children pretend to be bugs—crawling like beetles, fluttering like butterflies, or buzzing like bees. Talk about where their bug might live and what it might do. <i>EYLF: LO1.3, LO3.2</i>
Cognitive Play	• Where Bugs Live – Provide images or small mats showing places bugs are often found (garden, soil, leaves). Children place bugs where they think they belong, moving them freely. <i>EYLF: LO4.1</i> • Butterfly Life Cycle Exploration – Provide simple visual cards or a poster showing the butterfly life cycle alongside toy insects, loose parts or natural materials. Children explore the images freely, placing, moving and revisiting stages in their own way without expectation of sequence or explanation. <i>EYLF: LO4.1, LO2.4</i>
Communication and Language	• Bug and Insect Books – Share books that feature bugs and insects during group times. Stories can be revisited across the week alongside outdoor and nature play. <i>EYLF: LO5.1, LO5.2</i> ◦ <i>The Very Hungry Caterpillar, Hello Bug!, My Country (by Sally Morgan)</i>

Animals – Animals and Habitats

Focus of Learning	Use this page when children are:	Next Steps / Extension Ideas:
Toddlers explore where animals live through play, materials and visual experiences. By engaging with different environments such as land, water and vegetation, children notice how animals belong to different places and move between spaces through exploration and repetition.	• Showing interest in different animals and environments • Engaging with animal figures across play areas • Talking about animals seen in books, media or play • Exploring water, natural materials or outdoor spaces	

Domain	Activity Ideas
Sensory and Nature Play	• Sea Animals Play – Set up a shallow water tray with sea animals, shells, blue fabric or rocks. Children explore placing, floating, moving and submerging animals freely. <i>EYLF: LO2.4, LO3.1</i> • Jungle Animals Play – Provide a tray or floor space with jungle animals, leaves, vines, logs or fabric. Children move animals through dense materials, placing them under, over or between objects. – <i>EYLF: LO2.4, LO3.1</i> • Land Animals Play – Create a dry play space using dirt, sand, grass or bark with land animals. Children integrate animals into the materials naturally during play. <i>EYLF: LO2.4, LO3.1</i>
Creative Play	• Large-Scale Environment Art – Provide large paper or cardboard with paint, crayons or collage materials. Children create broad environments such as land, water or vegetation spaces for animals, with animals added during or after the artwork. <i>EYLF: LO4.1, LO2.2</i>
Cognitive Play	• Where Do I live? – Provide environment images (outback, ocean, farm) alongside a mixed set of animals. Children place, move and revisit animals across spaces in their own way. <i>EYLF: LO4.1</i>
Music and Movement	• Animal Dance – Play music or animal sounds and invite children to dance like their favourite animal, or move their bodies in response to the sounds they hear. Children choose how they move and can change animals or movements freely as the sounds change. <i>EYLF: LO3.2, LO4.2</i>
Communication and Language	• Aboriginal Stories of Animals and Place (Group Time) – Share Aboriginal Dreamtime stories that feature animals connected to land, water and sky. Link to other learning naturally to embed ideas through the inquiry. <i>EYLF: LO2.4, LO5.1</i> ◦ <i>Over in the Ocean, Way Down Deep in the Deep Blue Sea, Welcome to Country (by Aunty Joy Murphy), My Country (by Sally Morgan)</i>

Animals – Australian Animals

Focus of Learning	Use this page when children are:	Next Steps / Extension Ideas:
Toddlers explore Australian animals through play experiences connected to land, movement, materials and story. By engaging with specific animals found on Country, children build familiarity with animals that belong to the Australian environment and explore how animals move, live and interact with the land.	• Showing interest in Australian animals • Engaging in animal play or storytelling • Exploring outdoor spaces and natural materials • Responding to movement, rhythm and visual stories	

Domain	Activity Ideas
Sensory and Nature Play	• Australian Animal Movement – Include large open space and soft mats so children can safely imitate hopping kangaroos, waddling emus, or slithering snakes, encouraging gross-motor exploration. <i>LO3.2, LO1.1.</i> • Australian Bushland Sensory Bin – Fill a low bin with sand, soft eucalyptus bark shavings, and Australian animal figures. Children dig, sift, and nest the animals, noticing textures and how the animals move through the “bushland.” <i>LO1.1, LO2.4, LO3.1, LO5.1</i>
Cognitive Play	• Match Australian Animals to Their Homes – Provide pictures of Australian environments (bush, river, desert, ocean) and Australian animal figures. Children place each animal in the home where it belongs. Talk about why each animal lives there. <i>EYLF: LO4.1, LO2.4</i>
Creative Play	• Animal Tracks Painting – Provide animal figurines to dip into paint and create animal tracks. Children are also invited to paint their own animal tracks using a range of media. <i>EYLF: LO4.1, LO5.3</i> • Build an Animal Place – Provide blocks, loose parts and natural materials and invite children to build places for kangaroos, emus or wombats to rest or move through. <i>EYLF: LO4.1, LO2.2</i>
Dramatic Play	• Animal Family Play – Set out boxes, fabric tunnels, a large “pouch” for kangaroo joeys and a soft “nest” for emu eggs, inviting children to move wombats, kangaroos and other native animals in and out of the burrows. This open-ended setup encourages exploration of hiding, resting and different parental-care strategies. <i>EYLF: LO1.1, LO1.3</i>
Communication and Language	• Aboriginal Stories – Share Aboriginal stories that feature animals and the land. Use storybooks or oral storytelling and allow children to engage through listening, looking at images, repeating familiar parts and revisiting the stories over time. <i>EYLF: LO2.4, LO5.1</i> ◦ <i>Examples: The Rainbow Serpent, Tiddalik the Frog, How the Kangaroo Got Its Pouch, Why the Emu Can't Fly, Emu in the Sky, The Seven Sisters</i>

Animals – Caring for Animals

Focus of Learning	Use this page when children are:	Next Steps / Extension Ideas:
Toddlers explore relationships between animals and their young through play, storytelling and shared experiences. By engaging with animal families and babies, children develop empathy, connection and understanding of care, closeness and belonging in ways that reflect their own lived experiences.	• Showing interest in animal babies or families • Engaging in pretend play involving care or routines • Talking about families, parents or babies • Returning to animal play across the day	

Domain	Activity Ideas
Dramatic Play	• Animal Family Play – Provide animal figures that include adults and babies, along with simple props such as baskets, fabric, beds or shelters. Children engage in pretend play involving families staying together, resting or moving through spaces. EYLF: LO1.1, LO1.3
Cognitive Play	• Match the Babies – Offer animal sets with adults and babies. Children freely explore matching, grouping or separating animals, making connections as they play. EYLF: LO4.1 • Animal Families Sorting – Provide small trays or spaces for children to group animals into families in their own way, revisiting and rearranging throughout play. EYLF: LO4.2
Sensory and Nature Play	• Soft Spaces for Babies – Create a sensory play area using soft fabrics, natural materials and baskets to support animal baby play. Children explore placing, covering or resting animals within the space. EYLF: LO3.1, LO2.4
Creative Play	• Draw an Animal Family – Provide paper and drawing or collage materials for children to create animal families in their own way, without expectation of representation. EYLF: LO4.1, LO5.3 • Build a Family Space – Use blocks, boxes or loose parts to build spaces where animal families can stay together. EYLF: LO4.1, LO2.2
Communication and Language	• Caring for Country, Caring for Animals – Talk about how Aboriginal people teach children to care for all living things, including animal babies, as part of caring for Country. When we look after animals, we are looking after the land and each other. EYLF: LO2.4, LO1.3 • Animal Families Stories – Share books and stories that feature animal parents and babies during group times. Books remain available for children to revisit across the day. EYLF: LO5.1, LO5.2 ◦ <i>Are You My Mother?, Baby Animals, Mama Loves You So, My Country (by Sally Morgan)</i>



Celebrations

People in Our
Community

Food and
Community

Places in the
Community

Community

Transport

Cultures in Our
Community



Community – People in the Community

Focus of Learning	Use this page when children are:	Next Steps / Extension Ideas:
Toddlers explore people in their community through play experiences that reflect everyday roles, relationships and shared spaces. By engaging with familiar and unfamiliar community figures, children begin to notice how people contribute, help and belong within the places around them.	• Showing interest in people they see in the community • Engaging in pretend play involving everyday roles • Noticing uniforms, tools or community spaces • Talking about places they visit with family	

Domain	Activity Ideas
Dramatic Play	• Community Role Play – Set up a dramatic play area with props such as hats, bags, clipboards, clothing, tools and everyday items that reflect a range of community roles. Include open-ended materials that allow children to create their own scenarios. <i>EYLF: LO1.1, LO1.3</i> • Doctor and Care Play – Provide dolls, teddies, bandages, cloths, containers and simple medical-style props to support play focused on caring for others in a health setting. <i>EYLF: LO1.2, LO2.1</i> • Builder and Repair Play – Offer tools, blocks, boxes, safety vests and recycled materials to support play related to building, fixing and maintaining community spaces. <i>EYLF: LO4.1, LO2.2</i>
Creative Play	• People Collage – Provide magazines, photos and collage materials showing a variety of people in community roles. Materials are available for cutting, arranging and layering. <i>EYLF: LO4.1, LO5.3</i> • Design a Community Worker – Offer drawing tools, loose parts and recycled materials for children to create representations of people who work in the community. <i>EYLF: LO4.1</i>
Sensory and Nature Play	• Community Tools Exploration – Provide safe, real-life tools and materials used in community work (e.g. brushes, sponges, wooden tools, containers, fabric). Arrange materials for hands-on exploration. Include materials that represent people from different cultures and backgrounds, including Aboriginal community members. <i>EYLF: LO3.1, LO4.2</i>
Motor Skills	• Construction Corner – Set up a dedicated construction area with a range of building materials such as blocks, LEGO®, boxes and loose parts. Include hard hats, safety vests, real construction signs and images to support large-scale building and construction play. <i>EYLF: LO3.2, LO4.1</i>
Music & Movement	• Community Musicians Play – Provide instruments, sound-makers and scarves or ribbons to represent musicians and performers in the community (e.g. buskers, cultural musicians, performers at community events). Set up an open space for children to explore sound and movement through music-making and dance. <i>EYLF: LO3.2, LO5.1</i>
Communication and Language	• Aboriginal Community Roles – Talk about the important roles Aboriginal people have in communities today: Elders who share knowledge and stories, people who care for Country, artists who share culture through art, and educators who teach language and traditions. Display photos or invite local Aboriginal community members to share their roles. <i>EYLF: LO2.4, LO1.3</i>

Community – Places in Our Community

Focus of Learning	Use this page when children are:	Next Steps / Extension Ideas:
Toddlers explore places in the community through play experiences connected to real environments, shared spaces and familiar locations. By engaging with representations of community places and, where possible, visiting them, children build awareness of place, belonging and shared responsibility.	• Showing interest in people they see in the community • Engaging in pretend play involving everyday roles • Noticing uniforms, tools or community spaces • Talking about places they visit with family	

Domain	Activity Ideas
Dramatic Play	• Shop and Market Play – Set up a shop or market area using baskets, containers, bags, pretend food and recycled packaging to represent local shops and markets. <i>EYLF: LO1.1, LO2.1</i> • Library and Story Space – Create a quiet play space with books, cushions, baskets and simple signs to represent a library or shared reading place in the community. <i>EYLF: LO1.2, LO5.1</i> • Streets and Pathways Construction – Offer blocks, planks, ramps, tape and signs to build streets, footpaths and crossings for people and vehicles to move through. <i>EYLF: LO3.2, LO4.2</i>
Sensory and Nature Play	• Park Play Setup / Local Park Visit – Educators choose the option that best suits their context. <i>EYLF: LO2.4, LO3.1</i> ◦ Option A: Set up a park play environment using natural materials, people figures and loose parts to represent a local park space. ◦ Option B: Where possible, visit a local park as an excursion and allow children to explore the space directly. • Caring for Shared Places – Provide brooms, cloths, watering cans, gardening tools and bins to support play focused on looking after community spaces indoors or outdoors. <i>EYLF: LO2.1, LO2.4</i>
Cognitive Play	• Community Small World Map – Create a large floor or table map using roads, paths, buildings and landmarks such as parks, shops and libraries. Include people, vehicles and loose parts for open-ended exploration. <i>EYLF: LO4.1, LO4.2</i> • Community Signs Exploration – Provide real or replica community signs (e.g. stop, open/closed, pedestrian crossing, toilet, library) for placement and use within play spaces. <i>EYLF: LO4.2</i>
Creative Play	• Draw a Favourite Place – Provide a range of drawing materials for children to represent places they visit in the community, such as parks, shops or other familiar locations. Local pictures can be used as a reference. <i>EYLF: LO4.1, LO5.3</i>
Communication and Language	• Significant Places on Country – Talk about places that are special to Aboriginal people and Australia: meeting places, waterholes, sacred sites, and places where families gather. Discuss how Aboriginal people have cared for these places for thousands of years. <i>EYLF: LO2.4, LO3.1</i>

Community – Cultures in Our Community

Focus of Learning	Use this page when children are:	Next Steps / Extension Ideas:
Toddlers explore the cultures present within their community through shared experiences such as food, music, art, language and celebrations. Through play-based and everyday interactions, children encounter different ways of living, expressing and belonging within a community context.	• Showing interest in food, music, clothing or celebrations • Talking about family traditions from home • Engaging in group experiences involving movement, song or art • Exploring differences and similarities in people and practices	

Domain	Activity Ideas
Dramatic Play	• Cultural Dress and Textiles Play – Provide fabrics, wraps and clothing items representing cultures within the centre community for open-ended dramatic play. <i>EYLF: LO1.1, LO2.1</i>
Creative Play	• Pattern Making with Natural Colours – Provide natural pigments (ochre, clay, crushed berries, turmeric) and simple tools (sticks, fingers, leaves). Children explore making patterns and marks with the colours. Talk about how Aboriginal people use natural colours from Country for art and ceremony. <i>EYLF: LO5.3, LO2.4</i>
Sensory and Nature Play	• Cooking and Food Preparation Experiences – Engage children in simple, hands-on cooking or food preparation experiences drawn from cultures represented in the community, such as making damper, rolling flatbreads, washing rice, mixing dough or preparing fruit. <i>EYLF: LO3.1, LO2.1</i>
Communication and Language	• Cultural Story Sharing – Share stories that reflect cultures present within the community during group times. Books can remain accessible for revisiting. <i>EYLF: LO5.1, LO5.2</i> ◦ <i>Welcome to Country (by Auntie Joy Murphy), My Country (by Sally Morgan), Whoever You Are, All Through the Year</i> • Language and Greetings in Our Community – Share simple greetings or familiar words from languages spoken by families and educators, using books, audio recordings or family contributions. <i>EYLF: LO5.1</i> • Family and Educator Culture Sharing – Invite families and team members to share aspects of their culture with the group, such as singing, dancing, reading a story or speaking in their home language. <i>EYLF: LO1.3, LO2.1</i> • Aboriginal Culture Sharing – Invite an Aboriginal Elder or community member to share a story, song or language connected to Country, or use published resources created by Aboriginal authors and artists. <i>EYLF: LO2.4, LO5.1</i>
Music and Movement	• Cultural Music and Dance – Share music from cultures represented in the community, including Aboriginal, Pacific Islander, Indian, African, Asian and European cultures. Provide open space and simple props for movement and group dance. <i>EYLF: LO3.2</i>

Community – Food and Community

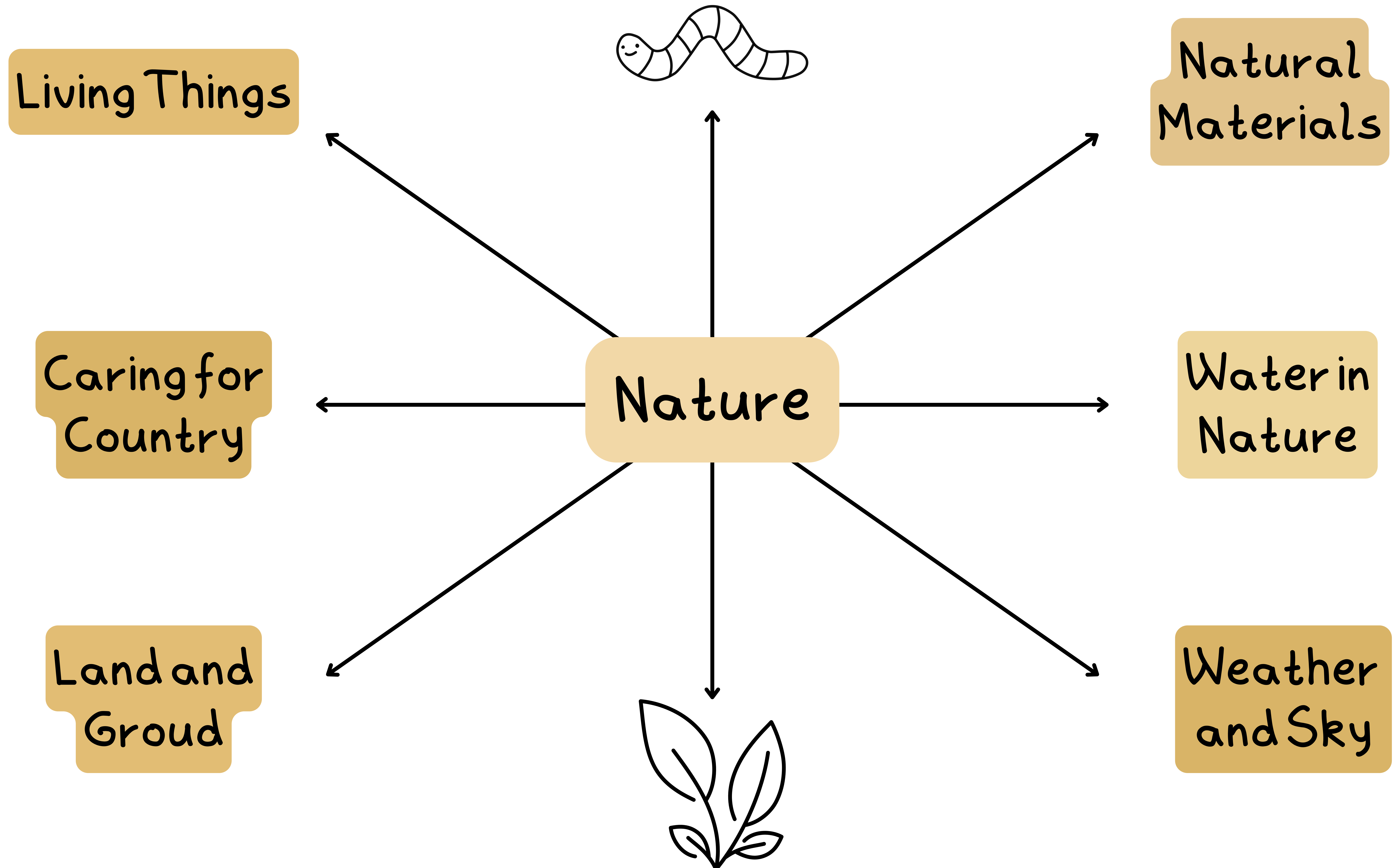
Focus of Learning	Use this page when children are:	Next Steps / Extension Ideas:
Toddlers explore how food brings people together through shared meals, cultural traditions, and community connections. By engaging with food-related play experiences, children begin to understand how food is grown, prepared, and shared within families and communities, including the roles of people who grow and make food.	• showing interest in food, cooking, or eating • engaging in pretend cooking, shopping, or farming play • talking about foods they eat at home • noticing different foods in books, the community • asking "Who makes this food?" or "Where does it come from?"	

Domain	Activity Ideas
Dramatic Play	• Shop and Market Play – Set up a shop or market area using baskets, containers, bags, pretend food, and recycled packaging. Children take turns being the shopper and the seller. <i>EYLF: LO1.1, LO2.1</i> • Kitchen and Cooking Play – Provide pots, pans, utensils, and pretend food. Children pretend to cook meals and serve them to others. Talk about "making," "stirring," and "serving." <i>EYLF: LO1.3, LO5.1</i> • Food Role Play – Provide props representing different food roles: chef's hat and apron (chef/baker), overalls and toy vegetables (farmer), shopping bag and basket (shopkeeper). Children choose a role and act out what that person does. <i>EYLF: LO1.3, LO2.1</i>
Sensory and Nature Play	• Pretend Food Washing – Provide a water tray with plastic fruits and vegetables. Children are invited to wash food ready for eating. <i>EYLF: LO3.1</i> • Soil and Planting Tray – Provide soil, seeds, and small pots. Children plant seeds and watch them grow over time. Talk about how farmers grow food from the earth. <i>EYLF: LO3.1, LO2.4</i>
Creative Play	• Food Collage – Provide glue, paper, and pictures of different foods. Children stick the pictures onto paper to create a "meal" or "plate." Talk about what foods they like. <i>EYLF: LO5.3, LO4.1</i> • Playdough Food – Provide playdough and simple tools. Children create pretend foods (balls for apples, long shapes for sausages). Talk about what they are making. <i>EYLF: LO5.3, LO4.1</i>
Communication and Language	• Food Books – Share books about food, cooking, and sharing meals during group times. Books remain accessible for revisiting. <i>EYLF: LO5.1, LO5.2</i> ◦ Suggested book examples: <i>The Very Hungry Caterpillar (Eric Carle), Feast for Ten (Cathryn Falwell), Bilby Moon (Margaret Spurling), My Country (Sally Morgan), The Rainbow Serpent (Bob Graham)</i>
Communication and Language	• Match the Food – Provide pictures of foods and where they come from (apple/tree, egg/chicken, milk/cow, wheat/bread). Children match the food to its source. <i>EYLF: LO4.1, LO2.4</i> • Match the Role – Provide pictures of food roles (farmer, baker, chef, shopkeeper) and the tools they use (tractor, oven, knife, cash register). Children match the role to the tool. <i>EYLF: LO4.1, LO4.2</i>

Community – Celebrations

Focus of Learning	Use this page when children are:	Next Steps / Extension Ideas:
Toddlers explore how communities celebrate through special events, traditions, and shared experiences. By engaging with celebration-themed play, children begin to understand that different people celebrate in different ways, and that celebrations bring people together.	• showing interest in festivals, parties, or special events • talking about celebrations at home • noticing decorations, lights, colours, or special foods • engaging in pretend celebration play • participating in centre celebrations or cultural events	

Domain	Activity Ideas
Dramatic Play	• Cultural Celebration Corner – Set up a play area with items from different celebrations: lanterns for Lunar New Year, rangoli materials for Diwali, colours for Holi, crescent moon decorations for Eid. Children explore the items and create their own celebration scenarios. Talk about "festival," "celebration," and "special." <i>EYLF: LO1.3, LO2.1</i> • Birthday Party Play – Provide hats, pretend cake, candles, wrapping paper, and gift bags. Children pretend to have birthday parties, wrapping and unwrapping gifts. Talk about "birthday," "party," and "celebrate." <i>EYLF: LO1.3, LO2.1</i> • Festival Food Play – Provide pretend foods from different cultures (mooncakes, sweets, bread, dates). Children pretend to prepare and share festival foods. Talk about "sharing," "eating together," and "special food." <i>EYLF: LO1.3, LO5.1</i>
Creative Play	• Lantern Making – Provide paper, tissue, glue, and string. Children create simple lanterns for Lunar New Year or Mid-Autumn Festival. <i>EYLF: LO5.3, LO4.1</i> • Rangoli Patterns – Provide coloured sand, rice, or chalk. Children create simple patterns on paper or the floor, inspired by Diwali rangoli designs. <i>EYLF: LO5.3, LO4.1</i> • Colour Play for Holi – Provide washable paint or chalk in bright colours. Children explore mixing colours and making marks, inspired by Holi's celebration of colours. <i>EYLF: LO5.3, LO4.1</i> • Birthday Party Hat Making – Provide plain paper hats or headbands, stickers, crayons, and collage materials. Children decorate their own party hats. <i>EYLF: LO5.3, LO4.1</i>
Music and Movement	• Celebration Dance – Play music from different celebrations (Chinese New Year drums, Bollywood music for Diwali, Arabic music for Eid, birthday songs). Children dance and move to the music. <i>EYLF: LO3.2, LO5.1</i> • Musical Games – Set up simple party games like musical statues or pass the parcel. Children participate in turn-taking and shared fun. <i>EYLF: LO3.2, LO1.3</i> • Movement Stories – Tell simple stories about celebrations and invite children to move like characters in the story (e.g., "dance like we're celebrating," "walk like we're going to a festival"). <i>EYLF: LO3.2, LO5.1</i>
Communication and Language	• Language and Greetings – Share simple greetings from different celebrations: "Happy New Year," "Diwali Mubarak," "Eid Mubarak," "Happy Birthday." Children practise saying them. <i>EYLF: LO5.1, LO2.1</i>



Nature – Natural Materials

Focus of Learning	Use this page when children are:	Next Steps / Extension Ideas:
Toddlers explore the natural world through hands-on experiences with materials found on Country. By engaging with natural materials through play, children begin to notice textures, weight, sound and change, developing familiarity and respect for the environment around them.	• Collecting or showing interest in natural materials outdoors • Engaging in sensory or exploratory play • Carrying, placing or examining objects during play • Spending extended time in outdoor environments	

Domain	Activity Ideas
Sensory and Nature Play	• Loose-Parts Discovery Basket – Offer a rotating basket of sticks, leaves, bark, seed-pods and stones; toddlers freely explore textures, stack or nest items, and name what they notice. <i>LO3.1, LO4.2, LO5.1</i> • Nature Play with Mud –Set up a mud play area using soil and water, with access to bowls, spoons, scoops and containers. The space can remain open for children to return to as part of outdoor play. <i>EYLF: LO3.1</i> • Potions and Outdoor Kitchen Play – Offer natural materials such as leaves, petals, sand and water alongside outdoor kitchen-style utensils including pots, cups, ladles and trays. Materials are arranged to invite mixing and combining.. <i>EYLF: LO3.1, LO4.1</i> • Tools of Country – Provide a basket of natural materials (smooth stones, flat bark, sturdy sticks, dried grass). Talk about how Aboriginal people have used these exact materials for thousands of years to make tools (digging sticks, scrapers), shelters, and art. Invite children to explore how the materials feel and imagine what they could be used for. <i>EYLF: LO2.4, LO3.1</i>
Creative Play	• Nature-Ink Rubbings – Place a leaf or bark piece under paper; children rub a crayon over it to reveal patterns, then talk about the shape they see. <i>LO4.1, LO5.3, LO5.1</i> • Natural Materials in Playdough – Add natural materials such as sticks, stones, shells or seed pods to playdough experiences, with dough and tools set up on trays or tables for easy access. Materials can be provided or collected by children, swapped or added to over time. <i>EYLF: LO4.1</i>
Cognitive Play	• Sort by Texture – Provide a mix of natural materials (rough bark, smooth stones, soft leaves, prickly pinecones). Children sort them into "rough" and "smooth" or "soft" and "hard" groups. Talk about the words as they touch. <i>EYLF: LO4.1, LO4.2</i>
Dramatic Play	• Nest Making – Provide a collection of natural materials including twigs, leaves, bark and grasses in a defined outdoor or indoor space. Small animal figures or soft toys may be added as optional props. <i>EYLF: LO4.1, LO2.4</i> • Bug Houses – Provide containers, tubes or small boxes alongside natural materials such as bark, leaves and sticks to create simple bug houses in outdoor areas. Materials are positioned to support respectful use of the environment. <i>EYLF: LO2.4</i>
Communication & Language	• Nature Books – hare books that focus on nature and natural materials during group times. Books are also available in reading spaces for children to revisit throughout the day. <i>EYLF: LO5.1, LO5.2</i> ◦ <i>My Country (by Sally Morgan), Welcome to Country (by Aunt Joy Murphy), Leaf Man, Stick Man</i>

Nature – Water in Nature

Focus of Learning	Use this page when children are:	Next Steps / Extension Ideas:
Toddlers explore water as a natural element found on Country through play experiences that involve pouring, flowing, mixing and observing. Through repeated access to water play, children become familiar with how water moves, changes and interacts with natural materials.	• Drawn to water, puddles or rain • Engaging in sensory or exploratory outdoor play • Interested in pouring, filling or watching water move • Spending time outdoors in changing weather	

Domain	Activity Ideas
Sensory and Nature Play	• Water Exploration Trays – Provide shallow trays or tubs with water, alongside cups, jugs, funnels and containers. Set up on tables or outdoor surfaces with easy access and drainage. <i>EYLF: LO3.1</i> • Water and Natural Materials – Fill a shallow tray with water, add stones, leaves and a few floating natural objects; toddlers pour, splash and observe what sinks or floats. <i>LO3.1, LO4.2, LO5.1</i> • Flowing Water Play – Set up simple water flow using gutters, tubing, trays or sloped surfaces outdoors. Water is poured or directed through the setup as part of free play. <i>EYLF: LO3.1</i> • Water on Country – Set up a water tray with natural materials (stones, leaves, bark). Talk about how Aboriginal people have always known where to find water (waterholes, billabongs, springs) and how they cared for these sources as sacred places essential for all life. Discuss how water flows and connects the land. <i>EYLF: LO2.4, LO3.1</i>
Cognitive Play	• Sink and Float Tray – Provide a shallow tray of water and a mix of natural materials (leaves, stones, bark, twigs). Children predict and test what sinks and what floats. Talk about "heavy," "light," "sink," and "float." <i>EYLF: LO4.1, LO4.2</i>
Creative Play	• Nature Boats – Provide natural and recycled materials such as bark, leaves, corks, sticks and paper alongside water trays or troughs for making simple floating constructions. <i>EYLF: LO4.1</i>
Dramatic Play	• Outdoor Water Kitchen – Offer outdoor kitchen-style equipment including pots, bowls, ladles and containers alongside water and natural materials. The space remains available for ongoing imaginative play. <i>EYLF: LO4.1</i>
Communication and Language	• Water and Rain Books (Group Time) – Share books that show water in nature, such as rain, rivers and oceans, during group times. Books remain accessible for revisiting. <i>EYLF: LO5.1, LO5.2</i> ◦ <i>Suggested book examples :My Country (by Sally Morgan), Rain, Water, Splash!</i>
Sustainability	• Caring for Water on Country – Set up water play with buckets, tubs or trays that allow educators to monitor and reuse water where appropriate, supporting respectful use of water during play. <i>EYLF: LO2.4</i>

Nature – Weather and Sky

Focus of Learning	Use this page when children are:	Next Steps / Extension Ideas:
Toddlers experience weather and sky as part of everyday life on Country through outdoor play, visual materials and shared experiences. Opportunities are provided to notice changes in light, temperature, wind and sky conditions across the day and over time.	• Spending extended time outdoors • Showing interest in the sky, sun, clouds or wind • Responding to changes in weather or temperature • Exploring outdoor spaces across different conditions	

Domain	Activity Ideas
Sensory and Nature Play	• Weather Observation Area – Set up a consistent outdoor or window-based space where children can look up at the sky. Include comfortable seating, shade where needed, and open views to notice clouds, light and movement in the sky. <i>EYLF: LO2.4, LO3.1</i> • Wind Play Setup – Provide materials that respond to airflow such as streamers, ribbons, pinwheels or fabric pieces in an outdoor area. Materials remain available for children to interact with as the wind changes. <i>EYLF: LO3.1</i>
Creative Play	• Sky and Weather Art Table – Offer blue, grey and white paper, chalks, paint, sponges or collage materials to explore marks, colours and textures inspired by the sky and weather. Materials are set out for open access rather than directed tasks. <i>EYLF: LO4.1</i> • Wind Chimes – Provide natural and recycled materials such as sticks, shells, seed pods, metal pieces or wooden shapes with string for creating simple wind chimes outdoors. Chimes are hung in areas where wind can move through them. <i>EYLF: LO3.1, LO4.1</i>
Music and Movement	• Weather-Inspired Movement – Introduce simple movement experiences connected to weather, such as moving arms like wind, stretching upward like the sun, or lowering bodies like rain falling. Movements are modelled briefly and then left open for children to explore. <i>EYLF: LO3.2</i>
Cognitive Play	• Cloud Observation and Images – Display clear photographic images of different cloud formations in an accessible space. These are used as visual references alongside real-time sky observations, without classification or recording expectations. <i>EYLF: LO4.2</i> • Weather Tracking Displays – Display simple daily or weekly weather visuals showing Western seasons and Aboriginal seasonal representations. These are used as reference points for noticing patterns over time, not for formal data collection. <i>EYLF: LO4.2, LO2.4</i> • Seasons on Country – Display simple images of the local Aboriginal seasonal calendar for your region. Talk about how Aboriginal people read the sky, wind, and animal behaviour to know what season it is and what to do (hunt, gather, move). <i>EYLF: LO2.4, LO4.2</i>
Sustainability	• Experiencing Weather on Country – Plan opportunities for children to spend time outdoors in a range of weather conditions, with appropriate clothing, shade and shelter available, supporting respectful engagement with natural environments. <i>EYLF: LO2.4</i>

Nature – Land and Ground

Focus of Learning	Use this page when children are:	Next Steps / Extension Ideas:
Toddlers explore land and ground on Country through play experiences involving soil, dirt, rocks and natural surfaces. Opportunities are provided to interact with the ground beneath them and the materials found within it as part of everyday outdoor play.	• Playing close to the ground or digging in soil • Interested in dirt, rocks, gravel or uneven surfaces • Engaging in outdoor sensory play • Spending extended time in natural outdoor spaces	

Domain	Activity Ideas
Sensory and Nature Play	• Soil and Dirt Play Area – Provide a defined outdoor area with access to soil or dirt, along with simple tools such as scoops, brushes, sifters and containers. The area remains available for repeated, open-ended play. <i>EYLF: LO3.1</i> • Mud Play Space – Set up a mud play area using soil and water, with bowls, spoons, trays and containers arranged for easy access. Materials remain available for children to return to throughout outdoor play. <i>EYLF: LO3.1</i> • Rocks and Stones Exploration – Offer a selection of rocks and stones on trays, low tables or ground mats for handling and exploration. Materials can be rotated or refreshed using what is found on Country. <i>EYLF: LO3.1, LO4.2</i> • Dig and Discover Area – Set up a small digging space using soil or sand with partially buried natural items such as stones, shells or sticks. Include hand tools like trowels and brushes arranged nearby for exploration. <i>EYLF: LO3.1, LO4.2</i> • Walking on Country – Invite children to walk barefoot (if safe) on different ground surfaces: grass, dirt, sand, smooth stones. Talk about how Aboriginal people have walked on this land for thousands of years, feeling the ground beneath their feet and knowing the stories it holds. <i>EYLF: LO2.4, LO3.1</i>
Creative Play	• Ground Mark Making – Provide chalk, water brushes or natural pigments for making marks on concrete, pavers, stones or other outdoor surfaces. Materials can be set out without instruction or expectation for open ended play. <i>EYLF: LO4.1</i> • Nature Imprints – Provide clay, damp sand or soft dough alongside natural materials such as leaves, stones and bark for pressing and imprinting. Materials are arranged on trays or tables for easy access. <i>EYLF: LO4.1</i>
Dramatic Play	• Small World on the Ground – Create a low-level play space using dirt, sand or gravel as a base, with simple figures or loose parts available to support imaginative play connected to land environments. <i>EYLF: LO4.1</i>
Cognitive Play	• Sort the Stones – Provide a collection of rocks and stones of different sizes, colours, and textures. Children are invited to sort them into groups (big/small, smooth/rough, light/dark). <i>EYLF: LO4.1, LO4.2</i>
Sustainability	• Caring for Ground Spaces – Offer opportunities for children to participate in caring for outdoor ground areas, such as gently returning materials, smoothing soil or watering dusty spaces as part of everyday outdoor routines. <i>EYLF: LO2.4</i>

Nature – Caring for Country

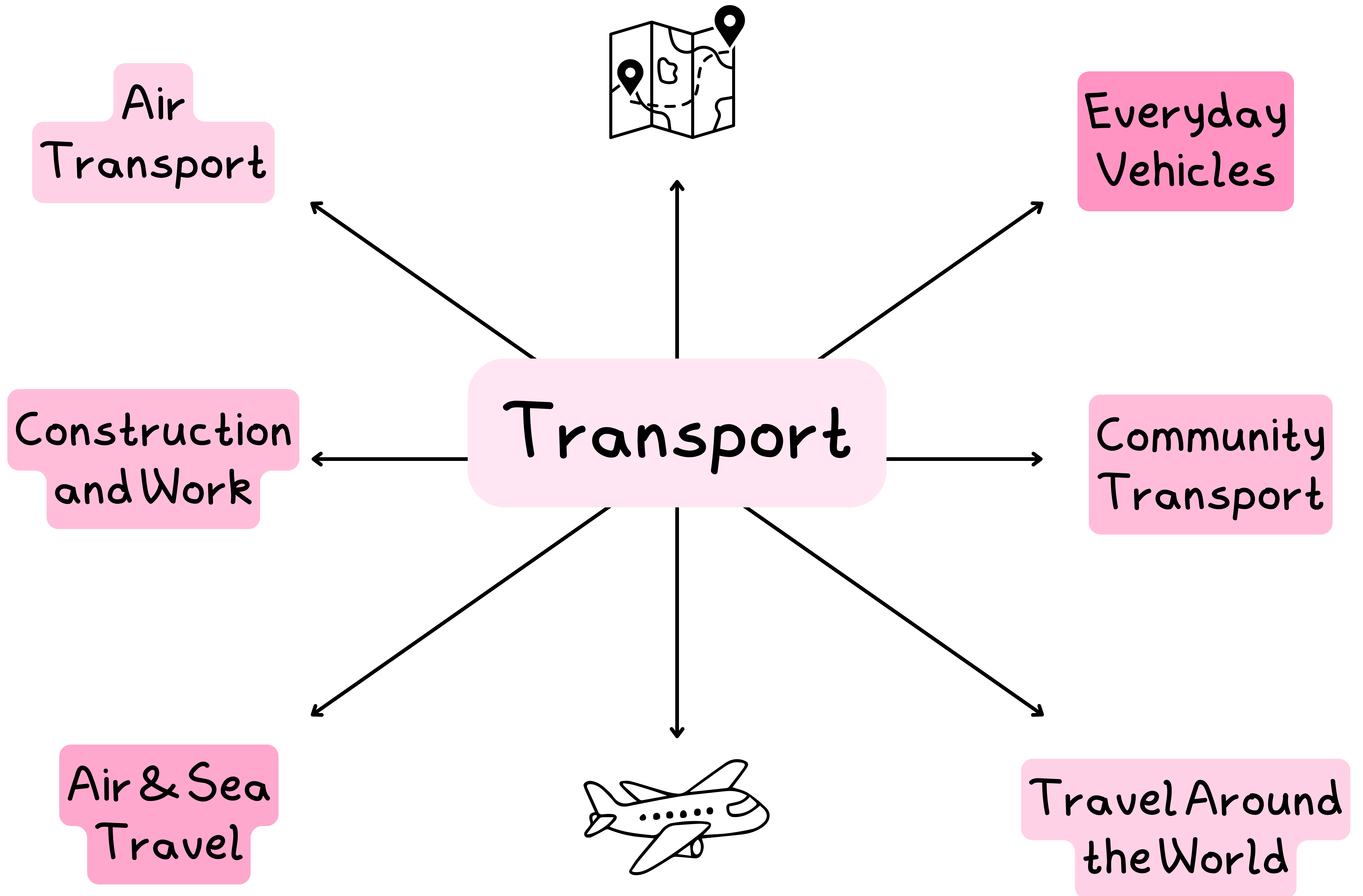
Focus of Learning	Use this page when children are:	Next Steps / Extension Ideas:
Toddlers engage in play experiences that introduce ways people care for land, water, plants and animals on Country. Through hands-on, everyday experiences, children encounter ideas of care, use and respect in concrete, age-appropriate ways.	- Engaging with natural and recycled materials - Showing interest in animals, plants or water - Exploring sorting, placing or creating during play - Spending time in shared indoor or outdoor spaces	

Domain	Activity Ideas
Sensory and Nature Play	Loose Parts on Country – Provide a small, intentional collection of natural materials such as sticks, stones or leaves within an outdoor space for building, arranging or imaginative play. Materials are gathered and returned to the same area as part of the play cycle. <i>EYLF: LO2.4, LO3.1</i> Ocean Clean-Up Water Tray – Set up a shallow water tray with toy sea animals and a small number of floating and sinking items. Provide scoops, strainers and baskets nearby so items can be removed, placed or transferred during water play. <i>EYLF: LO3.1</i>
Cognitive Play	Mini-Recycling Station – Low, labelled bins for recycle, compost and waste invite toddlers to place their snack wrappers, food scraps, paper and other rubbish into the correct bin throughout the day, reinforcing respect for resources. <i>LO2.4, LO3.1, LO5.1</i> Native Flowers and Bees Exploration – Set up a small play space with native flowers (real or artificial), bee figures and loose materials such as blocks or trays to represent garden areas where bees can land, rest or move between flowers. <i>EYLF: LO4.2</i>
Creative Play	Natural Art Resources – Offer paper or cardboard alongside leaves, flowers, sticks, seed pods or bark for gluing, printing or collage. <i>EYLF: LO4.1</i> Recycled Art Making – Provide boxes, tubes, lids and containers with tape or glue for open-ended construction using recycled materials. <i>EYLF: LO4.1</i> Nature and Reuse Construction – Offer a mix of natural materials (sticks, leaves, stones) and recycled items (boxes, tubes, lids) together for open-ended building and combining. <i>EYLF: LO4.1</i>
Dramatic Play	Caring for Animals Play – Provide toy animals, baskets, fabric pieces and small containers in a defined play area to support play involving feeding, resting or sheltering animals. <i>EYLF: LO2.1, LO4.1</i>
Communication and Language	Stories About Caring for Country – Share books that introduce ideas of land, water, animals and care through story. Books remain available for revisiting. <i>EYLF: LO5.1, LO5.2</i> <i>Suggested book examples: My Country, Welcome to Country, Somebody's Land, The Water Hole,</i>

Nature – Living Things

Focus of Learning	Use this page when children are:	Next Steps / Extension Ideas:
Toddlers encounter living things in their environment through everyday play experiences involving plants, insects and animals. Through observing, caring and interacting, children begin to notice that living things grow, move, need care and exist in different places on Country.	• Showing interest in insects, animals or plants • Noticing movement, growth or change in the environment • Engaging in caring or pretend caring play • Spending time outdoors in garden or natural spaces	

Domain	Activity Ideas
Sensory and Nature Play	• Garden Living Things Area – Set up access to garden beds, planter boxes or pots where children can notice plants, insects and soil as part of outdoor play. <i>EYLF: LO2.4, LO3.1</i> • Bug Observation Area – Set up a defined outdoor space near garden beds, plants or natural ground where insects are commonly seen. Provide visual prompts such as photos or simple images of insects to support noticing during play. <i>EYLF: LO2.4, LO4.2</i> • Bird and Animal Sounds Listening Area – Set up a quiet listening space indoors or outdoors with short recordings of birds and animals commonly found in the local environment. Include images or simple silhouettes nearby as visual reference. <i>EYLF: LO3.1, LO5.1</i> • All Living Things are Connected – Provide toy animals, insects, and plants. Talk about how Aboriginal people understand that all living things (plants, animals, insects, people) are connected and part of Country. When we care for one, we care for all. <i>EYLF: LO2.4, LO3.1</i>
Dramatic Play	• Caring for Living Things Play – Provide toy animals, insects or plants with baskets, fabric, bowls or small containers to support play involving feeding, resting or sheltering living things. <i>EYLF: LO2.1, LO4.1</i> • Living Things Habitat Building – Provide blocks, fabric, cardboard pieces and natural materials for children to create simple spaces where animals or insects might rest, hide or move through during play. <i>EYLF: LO4.1</i>
Cognitive Play	• Life Cycle Images and Objects – Display simple visual sequences showing growth or change (e.g. seed to plant, caterpillar to butterfly, egg to bird) alongside related objects or figures for exploration. <i>EYLF: LO4.2</i>
Motor Skills	• Animal and Insect Movement Play – Set up space indoors or outdoors with visual prompts of animals or insects to support jumping, crawling, stretching or flapping movements during play. <i>EYLF: LO3.2</i>
Communication and Language	• Living Things Books – Share books that show plants, insects and animals during group times. Books remain accessible for revisiting throughout the day. <i>EYLF: LO5.1, LO5.2</i> ◦ <i>Suggested book examples: Over in the Garden, Busy Beaks, Where the Forest Meets the Sea, The Water Hole, Flip, Float, Fly (by Jo Rippon), Hello, World! Garden Time</i>



Travel and Transport – Everyday Vehicles

Focus of Learning	Use this page when children are:	Next Steps / Extension Ideas:
Children explore familiar vehicles and how they move through hands-on play. This learning supports vocabulary development, cause-and-effect understanding, physical coordination, and connection to the vehicles children see in their daily lives.	• showing interest in vehicles during outdoor play or walks • making vehicle sounds during play (vroom, beep, choo-choo) • pushing, rolling, or racing toy vehicles • pretending to drive or steer during play • pointing to vehicles they recognise in books or outside	

Domain	Activity Ideas
Creative Play	• Box Car Build – Provide large cardboard boxes, tape, and simple decorating materials. Children work together to transform boxes into cars, trucks, or buses. Educator supports cutting and securing; children decide on design and decoration. <i>EYLF: LO4.1, LO2.1</i> • Vehicle Collage – Offer magazines, printed vehicle images, glue, and large paper. Children select and stick vehicle pictures to create a transport scene. <i>EYLF: LO5.3, LO4.1</i> • Tyre Track Painting – Dip toy vehicle tyres in washable paint and roll across large paper to create tracks. Children observe patterns and compare different vehicle sizes. <i>EYLF: LO4.2, LO5.3</i>
Music & Movement	• Vehicle Sound Game – Play recordings of vehicle sounds (car, bus, train, bike bell). Children are invited to guess the sound and move their bodies to match (steering, pedalling, waving). <i>EYLF: LO3.2, LO5.1</i> • Traffic Light Dance – Use red and green cards. Green means move (walk, run, pedal), red means stop. Children respond to colour changes with body movement. <i>EYLF: LO3.2, LO1.3</i>
Sensory & Nature Play	• Vehicle Sensory Bin – Fill a shallow container with sand, shredded paper, fabric scraps, or foam pieces. Bury toy vehicles for children to discover, dig out, and sort. <i>EYLF: LO3.1, LO4.2</i> • Tracks on Country – Provide a shallow tray with sand or soil. Children make marks with their hands, feet, or toy vehicles. Educator talks about how people have walked on this land for thousands of years, making tracks before cars existed. <i>EYLF: LO2.4, LO4.1</i>
Dramatic Play	• Garage and Repair Shop – Set up a space with toy tools, old keys, fabric, and cardboard boxes. Children act as mechanics, drivers, or customers. <i>EYLF: LO1.3, LO2.1</i> • Bus Stop Play – Create a simple bus stop with a sign, bench (or mats), and timetable (pictures). Children wait, board, and travel to different destinations. <i>EYLF: LO1.3, LO5.1</i>
Motor Skills	• Bike and Scooter Path – Provide bikes, scooters, and helmets. Set up a simple outdoor path with cones or chalk markings for children to navigate. <i>EYLF: LO3.2, LO4.3</i> • Push and Pull Vehicles – Offer ride-on toys, wagons, and push-cars. Children practice steering, stopping, and navigating around gentle obstacles. <i>EYLF: LO3.2, LO4.1</i>

Travel and Transport – Travel Around the World

Focus of Learning	Use this page when children are:	Next Steps / Extension Ideas:
Children begin to understand that people travel to different places near and far, and that different environments (sky, water, land) require different ways of moving. This learning supports curiosity about the world, vocabulary development, and early concepts of distance and place.	• talking about places they have visited • showing interest in maps, globes, or pictures of different places • noticing vehicles in books or photos that look different from everyday ones • comparing how they travel to how others might travel	

Domain	Activity Ideas
Dramatic Play	• Passport Stamp Station – Provide a simple "passport" (folded paper) and large stamps or stickers. Children "stamp" their passport when they visit different play areas. <i>EYLF: LO1.3, LO5.1</i> • Airport Check-In – Set up a counter with a bag and a sign. Children hand over their bag and receive a "boarding pass" (piece of paper) before moving to the next play area. <i>EYLF: LO1.3, LO5.1</i> • Walk on Country – Provide natural materials (sticks, stones, fabric). Children create simple paths and walk along them, talking about how people walked on this land before roads. <i>EYLF: LO2.4, LO3.2</i>
Sensory and Nature Play	• Water vs Land Texture Tray – Set up two shallow trays: one with water (for boats), one with sand or soil (for cars). Children move vehicles through each medium and notice the difference. <i>EYLF: LO3.1, LO4.2</i> • Cloud and Sky Observation – Sit outside and watch clouds move. Talk about how planes fly up there. Use cotton wool or white fabric to make "clouds" indoors. <i>EYLF: LO2.4, LO3.1</i>
Motor Skills / Physical Play	• Long Journey Obstacle Course – Create a longer path with multiple stations (crawl through tunnel = "under water", climb over cushion = "over mountain", walk on line = "cross bridge"). <i>EYLF: LO3.2, LO4.3</i> • Rolling Globe – Provide a large inflatable or soft globe. Children roll it to each other and stop it when told. <i>EYLF: LO3.2, LO4.1</i>
Communication and Language	• Travel Word Bank – Display simple pictures with words (plane, boat, walk, car). Children are invited to point to how they travelled today, or name the travel types they are familiar with. <i>EYLF: LO5.1, LO5.2</i> • Travel Around the World Books – Share books that show different vehicles, journeys, and how people travel in different places during group times. Books remain accessible for revisiting throughout the day. Educator uses simple questions like "What vehicle is this?" or "Where is it going?" to support language development. <i>EYLF: LO5.1, LO5.2</i> ◦ <i>Suggested book examples: The Little Engine That Could (Watty Piper), Where's My Mom? (Julia Donaldson), My Country (Sally Morgan), Welcome to Country (Aunty Joy Murphy), Busy Town (Richard Scarry), The Little Blue Truck (Alice Schertle), Flip, Float, Fly (Jo Rippon), Over in the Jungle (Marianne Berkes), Journey (Aaron Becker)</i>

Travel and Transport – Community Transport

Focus of Learning	Use this page when children are:	Next Steps / Extension Ideas:
Children explore the vehicles and people that help their community function—buses, trains, emergency vehicles, and the helpers who drive them. This learning supports understanding of community roles, helping behaviours, and how shared transport connects people.	• showing interest in sirens or emergency vehicles passing by • pretending to be helpers during play • talking about catching the bus, train, or tram with family • asking questions about what different vehicles do • noticing community vehicles near the service	

Domain	Activity Ideas
Creative Play	• Vehicle Design – Display pictures of community vehicles (ambulance, fire truck, police car, post bike, tram, train, bus) on a wall or easel. Children choose one and copy the picture using a range of media. Focus on observation and representation. EYLF: LO4.1, LO5.3
Motor Skills / Physical Play	• Hot Air Balloon Float – Children stand in a circle holding a large fabric sheet. They lift and lower it slowly to simulate a balloon rising and landing. EYLF: LO3.2, LO5.1 • Shared Pathway Ride – Mark a simple outdoor path with chalk. Children take turns riding bikes or scooters along the path, practising sharing space and waiting their turn. EYLF: LO3.2, LO1.3 • Tram Stop Waiting – Set up a marked area as a tram stop. Children practise standing in line, waiting for the "tram" (educator or toy), and boarding safely. EYLF: LO3.2, LO1.3
Dramatic Play	• Train Station Platform – Set up a platform with mats, a timetable (pictures), and a ticket counter (paper). Children wait, buy tickets, and board the train together. EYLF: LO1.3, LO5.1 • Post Person Delivery – Provide a bag, envelopes, and a toy vehicle. Children deliver mail to different "houses" (boxes or mats) around the room. EYLF: LO1.3, LO4.1 • Build a Bus from Chairs – Invite children to arrange chairs in rows to create a bus. Provide a steering wheel and simple props. Children choose roles (driver, passengers) and act out boarding, paying, and travelling to different places. EYLF: LO1.3, LO4.1
Communication and Language	• Community Transport Books – Share books that show emergency and community vehicles (ambulance, fire truck, police car, bus, train) during group times. Books remain accessible for revisiting throughout the day. Educator uses simple questions like "What does the ambulance do?" or "Where does the post bike go?" EYLF: LO5.1, LO5.2 ◦ <i>Little Ted's Big Book of Transport</i> (HarperCollins Australia), <i>Busy Bus</i> (Simon & Schuster Australia), <i>The ABC Book of Cars, Trains, Boats and Planes</i> (HarperCollins Australia), <i>Are We There Yet?</i> (Alison Lester), <i>Hello World</i> (Aura Parker) • Who Helps Us? – During group time, show pictures of community helpers (firefighter, paramedic, police officer, post person, bus driver). Invite children to match the helper to their vehicle. EYLF: LO5.1, LO1.1

Travel and Transport – Air & Sea Travel

Focus of Learning	Use this page when children are:	Next Steps / Extension Ideas:
Children explore how things move through air and water—floating, flying, sinking, and gliding. This learning supports early scientific thinking, sensory exploration, and understanding of different environments.	• watching planes in the sky or birds flying • splashing in puddles or playing with water • asking why things float or sink • making paper planes or watching things blow in the wind • noticing boats, ships, or water during outings	

Domain	Activity Ideas
Creative Play	• Floating Boat Construction – Offer recycled and natural materials (bark, leaves, plastic bottles, corks, foam trays) Children build simple boats to test in the water tray. Focus on the process of joining and testing. <i>EYLF: LO4.2, LO4.1</i> • Paper Plane Drop – Provide some pre-folded paper planes of different sizes and some ready to fold. Children drop them from a low height and observe how they fall (fast, slow, wobbly). <i>EYLF: LO4.2, LO3.2.</i>
Dramatic Play	• The Harbour – Lay blue fabric on the ground. Provide toy boats and a "dock" (wooden blocks or a bench). Children load and unload cargo (blocks, fabric) onto boats. <i>EYLF: LO1.3, LO4.1</i> • Life Jacket Practice – Provide child-sized life jackets or vests. Children practise putting them on and taking them off with educator support. <i>EYLF: LO3.2, LO1.3</i>
Communication & Language	• Air and Sea Books – Share books that explore flight and water travel during group times. Books remain accessible for revisiting throughout the day. Educator uses simple questions like "What flies in the sky?" or "What floats on the water?" <i>EYLF: LO5.1, LO5.2</i> ◦ <i>Suggested book examples: Who Sank the Boat? (Pamela Allen), The Wind Blew (Pat Hutchins), The Rainbow Fish (Marcus Pfister), Feathers for Phoebe (Rod Clement), Boats (Byron Barton)</i> • Ocean Sounds Listening – Play recordings of waves, seagulls, boat engines, and airplane flyovers. Children identify the sound and match it to a picture card. <i>EYLF: LO5.1, LO3.2</i>
Cognitive Play	• Sort by Medium – Provide pictures of vehicles (plane, helicopter, boat, ship, submarine). Children sort them into "sky" and "water" groups using their own reasoning. <i>EYLF: LO4.1, LO4.2</i> • What Floats? Prediction – Before testing materials in water, ask children to predict what will sink or float. Record predictions with simple marks or stickers. <i>EYLF: LO4.2, LO4.3</i>
Sensory and Nature Play	• Waterways on Country – Provide a shallow water tray with natural materials (leaves, bark, sticks). Children float materials and talk about how rivers and waterways have always been important for travel on Country. Educator uses language like "Rivers have carried people and things for thousands of years." <i>EYLF: LO2.4, LO3.1</i>

Travel and Transport – Construction and Work

Focus of Learning	Use this page when children are:	Next Steps / Extension Ideas:
Children explore how construction vehicles work—digging, lifting, dumping, and building. This learning supports understanding of cause and effect, physical coordination, and appreciation of the work that builds our communities.	• showing interest in diggers, cranes, or trucks passing by • digging in sand or dirt during outdoor play • pretending to build or construct with blocks • asking questions about how machines work • loading and dumping materials during play	

Domain	Activity Ideas
Creative Play	• Build a Construction Site – Provide cardboard boxes, blocks, and loose parts. Children create a building site and use toy construction vehicles to move materials around. Focus on the action of loading, dumping, and lifting. EYLF: LO4.1, LO2.1 • Vehicle Track Painting – Dip toy vehicle tyres in washable paint and roll across large paper. Compare different track patterns from different vehicles (digger, truck, crane). EYLF: LO5.3, LO4.2
Dramatic Play	• Construction Crew – Set up a space with hard hats, vests, and toy tools. Children take on roles (driver, worker, supervisor) and act out building tasks. EYLF: LO1.3, LO2.1 • Delivery Drop-Off – Provide a toy truck and blocks. Children load blocks into the truck and deliver them to different "buildings" (boxes or mats) around the room. EYLF: LO1.3, LO4.1
Sensory and Nature Play	• Mud Kitchen Mix – Provide dirt, water, and cups. Children mix "cement" and pour it into containers. Observe how wet and dry materials feel different. EYLF: LO3.1, LO4.1 • Building on Country – Provide sand, soil, and natural materials. Children dig, pile, and construct. Educator talks about how Aboriginal people have built shelters and structures on Country for thousands of years using natural materials. EYLF: LO2.4, LO4.1
Cognitive Play	• Vehicle Match – Provide pictures of construction vehicles and toy models. Children match the picture to the toy. EYLF: LO4.1, LO5.1 • Load and Count – Provide a toy dump truck and small blocks. Children count how many blocks fit in the truck before dumping. EYLF: LO4.3, LO4.1
Communication and Language	• Construction Books – Share books that show construction vehicles during group times. Books remain accessible for revisiting throughout the day. Educator uses simple questions like "What does the digger do?" or "Where is the truck going?" EYLF: LO5.1, LO5.2 ◦ Suggested book examples: <i>Big Machines</i> (DK Australia), <i>Diggers and Dumpers</i> (Roger Priddy), <i>Construction Site</i> (various), <i>Trucks and Diggers</i> (Byron Barton) • What Does It Do? – During group time, show pictures of construction vehicles. Ask children to name the vehicle and what work it does. EYLF: LO5.1, LO1.1

Travel and Transport – Travel Safety

Focus of Learning	Use this page when children are:	Next Steps / Extension Ideas:
Children explore how to stay safe when travelling—stopping, looking, holding hands, and wearing protective gear. This learning supports body awareness, impulse control, and understanding of simple rules that keep us safe.	• showing interest in helmets, seatbelts, or safety gear • playing "stop and go" games • asking questions about crossing roads safely • pretending to be crossing guards or police officers	

Domain	Activity Ideas
Communication and Language	• Safe Words Game – Introduce simple safety words like "Stop," "Wait," "Hold Hands," and "Look." Use a drum or bell to signal when to say the word and freeze. <i>EYLF: LO5.1, LO3.2</i> • Safety Book Time – Share books that focus on safety during group times. Books remain accessible for revisiting throughout the day. Educator uses simple questions like "What does this sign mean?" or "Why do we wear a helmet?" <i>EYLF: LO5.1, LO5.2</i> ◦ Suggested book examples: <i>Who Wears a Helmet? (Kids and Traffic, Macquarie University)</i>, <i>That's The Sound the Street Makes (Danny Katz)</i>, <i>Ziggy's Road Safety Stories (Starting Out Safely)</i>, <i>Susie & Sam Learn About Road Safety (various)</i>, <i>Watch Out! On the Road (Claire Llewelyn)</i>
Dramatic Play	• Crossing Guard Role – Set up a pretend crossing with tape lines on the floor. One child (or educator) holds a "Stop/Go" paddle. Others practise stopping, looking, and crossing safely when given the signal. <i>EYLF: LO1.3, LO3.2</i>
Creative Play	• Design a Helmet – Provide paper bowls, cardboard, fabric scraps, and decorating materials. Children create their own helmet designs and talk about what makes it safe (hard shell, straps, padding). <i>EYLF: LO5.3, LO4.1</i>
Music and Movement	• Red Light, Green Light – Green means move (walk, run, skip), yellow is slow down, red means stop and freeze. Use actual pictures of traffic lights if possible. <i>EYLF: LO3.2, LO1.3</i> • Hold Hands March – Children pair up and march in a line, holding hands. Stop when the music stops, then continue. Focus on staying connected. <i>EYLF: LO3.2, LO1.3</i>
Cognitive Play	• Safe vs Unsafe Sort – Provide pictures of safe behaviours (wearing a helmet, holding hands) and unsafe ones (running into the road, no seatbelt). Children sort them into "Safe" and "Not Safe" piles. <i>EYLF: LO4.1, LO4.2</i> • What Do I Need? – Show pictures of different trips (bike ride, car ride, walking). Children choose the correct safety item (helmet, seatbelt, holding hands) for each trip. <i>EYLF: LO4.1, LO5.1</i>



Dinosaur Food

Movement &
Behaviour

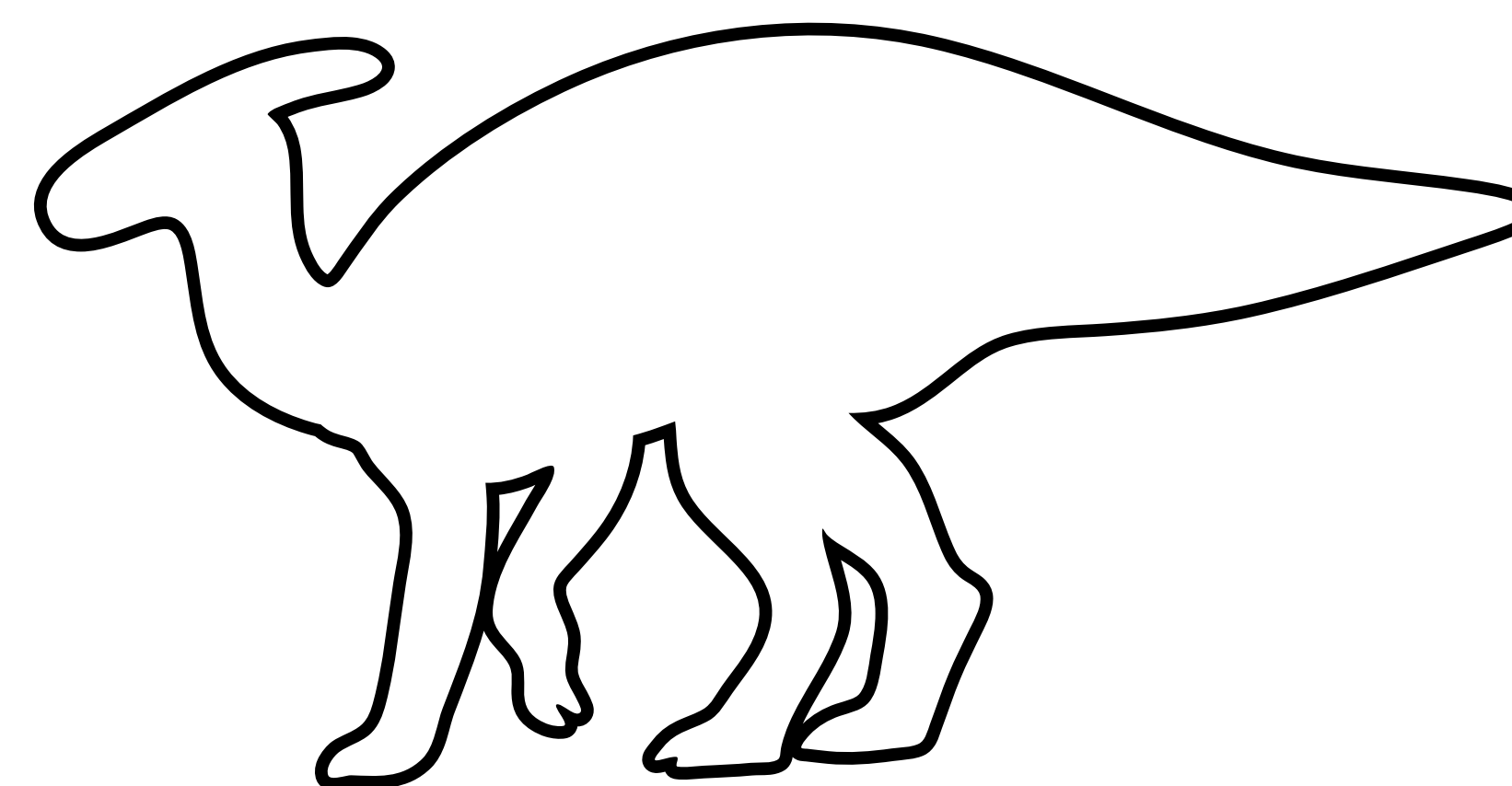
Homes and
Habitats

Dinosaur Eggs
& Babies

Dinosaurs

Fossils

Sizes and
Shapes



Dinosaurs – Movement & Behaviour

Focus of Learning	Use this page when children are:	Next Steps / Extension Ideas:
Children explore how dinosaurs moved their bodies—stomping, creeping, stretching, and swaying. This learning supports gross motor development, body awareness, rhythm, and understanding of how different animals move in different ways.	• showing interest in how dinosaurs walk, run, stomp, glide or hunt • comparing different dinosaurs’ bodies and movement • engaging in dramatic dinosaur play • asking questions about speed, size or actions • exploring movement patterns during outdoor play	

Domain	Activity Ideas
Motor Skills	• Dino Stomp Trail – Print or draw large dinosaur footprints and tape them to the floor in a winding line. Children are invited to stomp along the trail, choosing to go loud (big dinosaur) or quiet (small dinosaur). <i>EYLF: LO3.2, LO4.1</i> • Big and Small Moves – Play music with different tempos. When the beat is heavy and slow, children move like big dinosaurs (stomping, arms wide). When the music is light and fast, they move like small dinosaurs (tiptoeing, crouching). <i>EYLF: LO3.2, LO5.1</i>
Dramatic Play	• Long-Neck Reach – Hang scarves or leaves from a low bar or string. Children stretch up high like long-necked dinosaurs to "eat" the leaves. <i>EYLF: LO3.2, LO4.1</i> • Dino Freeze – Children move around the space like dinosaurs. When the educator calls "Freeze!", they stop and hold a dinosaur pose (tall, crouched, wings out). <i>EYLF: LO3.2, LO1.3</i>
Sensory and Nature Play	• Tracks on Country – Provide a shallow tray with sand or soil. Children make tracks with their hands, feet, or toy dinosaurs. Educator talks about how Aboriginal people have read animal tracks on Country for thousands of years to find food and water. <i>EYLF: LO2.4, LO3.1</i> • Texture Walk – Create a path with different surfaces (grass mat, sand tray, smooth fabric, bubble wrap). Children walk barefoot like a dinosaur and talk about how each surface feels under their feet. <i>EYLF: LO3.1, LO5.1</i>
Communication and Language	• Dinosaur Movement Books – Share books that show how animals move during group times. Books remain accessible for revisiting throughout the day. Educator uses simple questions like "How does this dinosaur move?" or "Can you stomp like a dinosaur?" <i>EYLF: LO5.1, LO5.2</i> ◦ Suggested book examples: <i>Dinosaur Roar! (Paul Strickland), Stomp, Dinosaur, Stomp! (Margaret Mayo), Dinosaurs Love Underpants (Claire Freedman)</i>
Creative Play	• Dino Footprint Painting – Dip toy dinosaur feet in washable paint and stamp them across large paper. Compare big footprints and small footprints. <i>EYLF: LO5.3, LO4.2</i> • Make a Dino Tail – Provide fabric strips, socks, or ribbons. Children create their own dinosaur tails to wear during movement play. <i>EYLF: LO5.3, LO4.1</i>

Dinosaurs – Homes and Habitats

Focus of Learning	Use this page when children are:	Next Steps / Extension Ideas:
Children explore where dinosaurs might have lived—forests, plains, and rocky areas. This learning supports sensory exploration, understanding of environments, and early concepts of where animals find shelter and food.	• asking "Where does the dinosaur live?" or "What is their home?" • playing with sand, soil, or natural materials to create spaces • showing interest in caves, nests, or sheltered areas • exploring different textures • pretending to hide or build a safe place for dinosaurs	

Domain	Activity Ideas
Sensory and Nature Play	• Prehistoric Mud Pit – Fill a shallow tray with soil, sand, or wet mud. Provide toy dinosaurs and natural materials (sticks, stones, leaves). Children dig, bury, and uncover the dinosaurs. <i>EYLF: LO3.1, LO4.2</i> • Build the Land – Provide sand, soil, bark, stones, and fabric. Children create their own landscape and talk about where dinosaurs might walk, sleep, or hide. Educator uses language like "This is soft for resting" or "This is hard for walking." <i>EYLF: LO2.4, LO4.1</i> • Dino Watering Hole – Fill a shallow tray with water and add toy dinosaurs, stones, and plants. Children explore how dinosaurs might drink, splash, or cool off in the water. Talk about why water is important for all living things. <i>EYLF: LO3.1, LO2.4</i> • Forest Sounds Movement – Play recordings of forest/jungle sounds (birds, wind, water). Children move like dinosaurs in that environment (slow through thick forest, quick near water). <i>EYLF: LO3.2, LO5.1</i>
Creative Play	• Build a Dino Home – Provide cardboard boxes, fabric, and blocks. Children are invited to create a "cave" or "forest" for their toy dinosaurs to hide in. <i>EYLF: LO4.1, LO5.3</i> • Dino Nest Making – Provide twigs, fabric scraps, and soft materials. Children are invited to build a nest for a baby dinosaur and talk about what makes it safe and comfortable. <i>EYLF: LO4.1, LO2.1</i> • Landscape Painting – Provide large paper and natural colours. Children are invited to paint their own dinosaur environment. <i>EYLF: LO5.3, LO4.1</i>
Dramatic Play	• Cave Hideout – Set up a tent or drape fabric over chairs to create a cave. Children go inside with their toy dinosaurs and pretend to rest or hide. <i>EYLF: LO1.3, LO4.1</i> • Forest Explorer – Provide magnifying glasses (toy) and baskets. Children walk through a "forest" (indoor or outdoor area with plants) and look for dinosaur signs. <i>EYLF: LO1.2, LO4.1</i> • Dino Family Care – Provide soft baby dinosaur toys and blankets. Children care for the babies by wrapping them, feeding them, and keeping them safe in their home. <i>EYLF: LO1.3, LO2.1</i>
Motor Skills	• Dino Path Obstacle Course – Set up a simple course with tunnels (caves), stepping stones (rocks), and low barriers (trees). Children navigate the path like a dinosaur exploring its home. <i>EYLF: LO3.2, LO4.3</i> • Carrying the Nest – Children carry soft materials (pillows, fabric) from one place to another to build a nest. Practise balancing and careful movement. <i>EYLF: LO3.2, LO4.1</i>

Dinosaurs – Eggs and Babies

Focus of Learning	Use this page when children are:	Next Steps / Extension Ideas:
Children explore the concept of dinosaur eggs hatching and caring for baby dinosaurs. This learning supports nurturing behaviours, understanding of growth and change, and early social-emotional skills through pretend care and protection.	• showing interest in eggs (cracking, opening, hatching) • pretending to care for babies or young animals • asking "Where do dinosaurs come from?" or "How do they hatch?" • wrapping, holding, or protecting small toys • talking about being a baby or when they were small	

Domain	Activity Ideas
Sensory and Nature Play	• Fizzing Egg Hatch – Mix baking soda and water to form a thick paste. Press small toy dinosaurs into the mixture and shape into egg-like balls. Freeze for 2 hours. Place frozen eggs in shallow trays and pour vinegar over them. Children watch the fizzing reaction and discover the dinosaur inside. Educator supports language like "Look, it's bubbling!" and "The dinosaur is coming out!" <i>EYLF: LO3.1, LO4.2</i> • Nest Building – Provide natural materials (twigs, leaves, grass, fabric scraps, soft fabric). Children build nests in a shallow tray or on the floor. Place baby dinosaur toys in the nests and talk about what makes a safe, comfortable home. <i>EYLF: LO4.1, LO2.1</i>
Dramatic Play	• Baby Dino Care – Provide soft baby dinosaur toys, blankets, and soft fabric. Children wrap, rock, and "feed" the babies with toy bottles or cups. Educator supports language like "The baby is sleeping" or "Let's keep it warm." <i>EYLF: LO1.3, LO2.1</i> • Dino Family – Provide adult and baby dinosaur toys of different sizes. Children create family groups and act out caring behaviours (protecting, feeding, sleeping together). <i>EYLF: LO1.3, LO4.1</i>
Communication and Language	• Dinosaur Babies Books – Share books that show baby animals or hatching during group times. Books remain accessible for revisiting throughout the day. Educator uses simple questions like "How does the baby come out?" or "What does the baby need?" <i>EYLF: LO5.1, LO5.2</i> ◦ Suggested book examples: <i>Dinosaur Roar! (Paul Strickland and Henrietta Strickland), How Do Dinosaurs Say Good Night? (Jane Yolen and Mark Teague), The Little Dinosaur (Gillian Pittard), Dinosaurs Love Underpants (Claire Freedman), Stomp,</i>
Cognitive Play	• Match Baby to Parent – Provide toy dinosaurs of different sizes. Children match the small baby to the big parent. <i>EYLF: LO4.1, LO4.2</i> • Order the Growth – Provide three pictures: egg, baby dinosaur, adult dinosaur. Children arrange them in order from smallest to biggest. <i>EYLF: LO4.3, LO4.1</i>

Dinosaurs – Dinosaur Food

Focus of Learning	Use this page when children are:	Next Steps / Extension Ideas:
Children explore what dinosaurs ate through sensory play, sorting, and feeding activities. This learning supports early classification skills, understanding of animal needs, and vocabulary development around food types and eating behaviours.	• asking "What do dinosaurs eat?" • pretending to feed animals or dinosaurs • showing interest in feeding toys or caring for creatures • exploring textures of different foods (leaves, sticks, soft fabric)	

Domain	Activity Ideas
Sensory and Nature Play	• Dinosaur's Dinner Bucket – Fill a shallow container with natural materials (leaves, twigs, bark). Provide toy dinosaurs and child-sized tongs. Children "feed" the dinosaurs and explore textures. Educator supports language like "This dinosaur eats plants" or "This one eats meat." <i>EYLF: LO3.1, LO4.2</i> • Mud Kitchen Feast – Provide dirt, water, cups, and spoons. Children mix "dinosaur food" (mud pies) and serve it to their toy dinosaurs. Talk about what dinosaurs might have eaten from the ground. <i>EYLF: LO3.1, LO4.1</i>
Dramatic Play	• Dino Cafe – Set up a pretend cafe with toy dinosaurs, plates, and natural materials (leaves, sticks, fabric). Children take turns being the server and the customer, feeding dinosaurs their favourite foods. <i>EYLF: LO1.3, LO5.1</i> • Feeding Time – Provide baby and adult dinosaur toys with different food types. Children act out feeding routines, talking about what each dinosaur needs to stay healthy. <i>EYLF: LO1.3, LO2.1</i>
Creative Play	• Dinosaur Food Collage – Provide large paper and natural materials (leaves, twigs, fabric scraps, paint). Children create a "dinosaur meal" by sticking materials onto paper. <i>EYLF: LO5.3, LO4.1</i> • Footprint Food Trail – Dip toy dinosaur feet in washable paint and stamp them across paper. Add "food" items (leaf prints, dot markers) along the trail to show what the dinosaur ate. <i>EYLF: LO5.3, LO4.2</i>
Motor Skills	• Tongs and Tweezers Feed – Provide child-sized tongs or tweezers and small food items (pom-poms, fabric scraps, leaves). Children pick up food and place it in dinosaur mouths or bowls. Practise fine motor control. <i>EYLF: LO3.2, LO4.1</i> • Carry the Food – Provide baskets or bags. Children carry food items from one place to another to feed dinosaurs. Practise balance and careful movement. <i>EYLF: LO3.2, LO4.1</i>
Communication and Language	• Dinosaur Food Books – Share books that show what animals eat during group times. Books remain accessible for revisiting throughout the day. Educator uses simple questions like "What does this dinosaur eat?" or "Is it a plant or meat eater?" <i>EYLF: LO5.1, LO5.2</i> ◦ Suggested book examples: <i>Dinosaur Roar! (Paul Strickland and Henrietta Strickland)</i>, <i>How Do Dinosaurs Eat Their Food? (Jane Yolen and Mark Teague)</i> • Food Talk – During group time, show pictures of different foods (leaves, plants, fish, meat). Ask children which dinosaurs might eat each one. <i>EYLF: LO5.1, LO4.1</i>

Dinosaurs – Sizes and Shapes

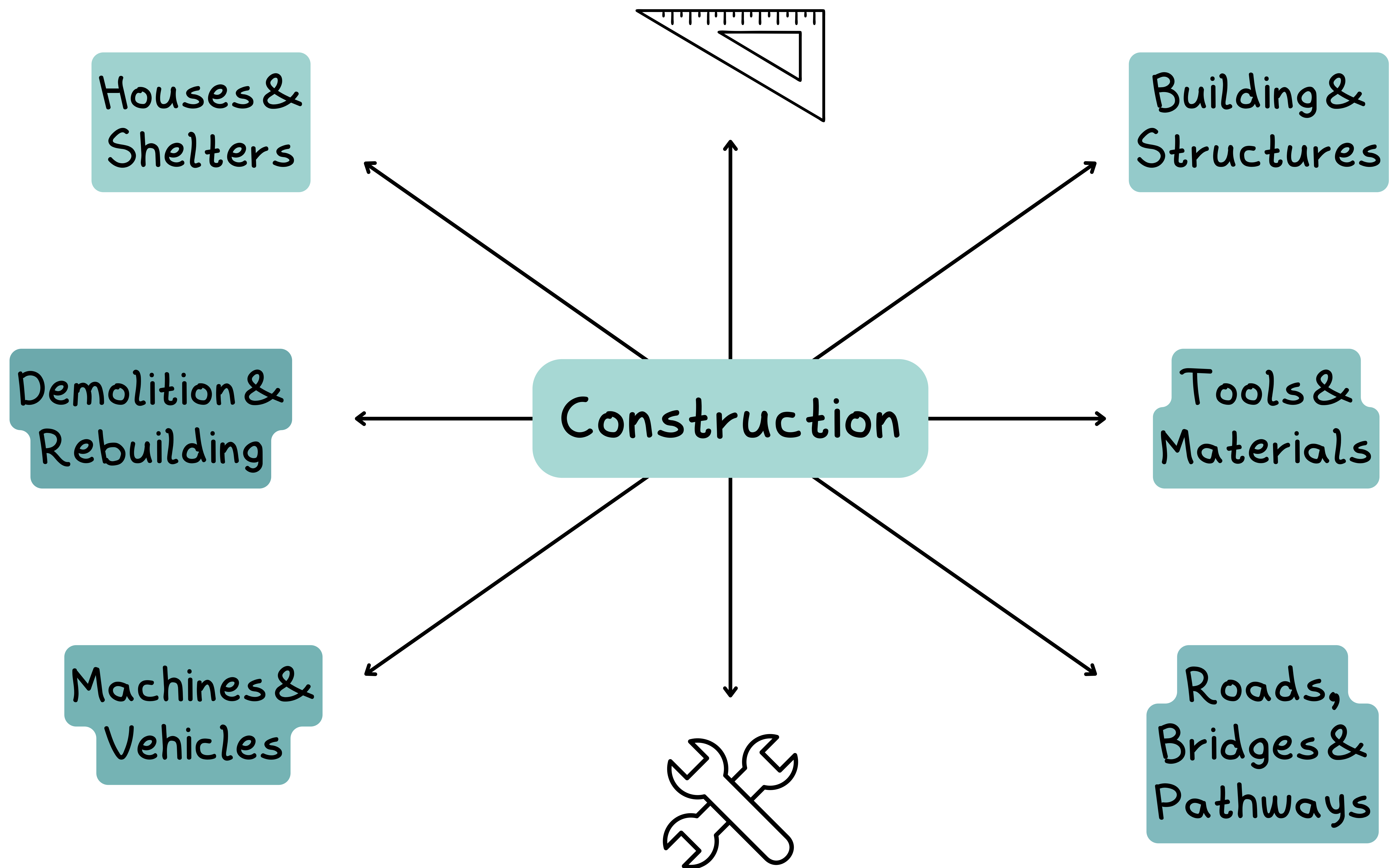
Focus of Learning	Use this page when children are:	Next Steps / Extension Ideas:
Children explore dinosaur sizes and shapes through comparison, measurement, and creative representation. This learning supports mathematical thinking, spatial awareness, and vocabulary development around size, length, and form.	• comparing dinosaur toys by size ("This one is bigger!") • asking "How long is that dinosaur?" or "Which is tallest?" • lining up dinosaurs from smallest to biggest • showing interest in shapes (long neck, round body, spiky tail) • using measurement words in play (big, small, long, short, tall)	

Domain	Activity Ideas
Motor Skills	• Big and Small Movement – Children are invited to stretch their arms wide and stomp heavily to be "big." Then they curl up small and tiptoe to be "small." Call out different dinosaur sizes and children move accordingly. <i>EYLF: LO3.2, LO4.1</i> • Footstep Pathways – Offer footprint markers or pathway markers for children to explore long strides, short steps, or wide stances inspired by dinosaur movement. <i>EYLF: LO3.2, LO4.1</i>
Cognitive Play	• Size Comparison Sort – Provide toy dinosaurs of different sizes. Children sort them into groups (big, medium, small) using their own reasoning. Educator supports language like "Which one is the biggest?" <i>EYLF: LO4.1, LO4.2</i> • Measure with Blocks – Line up toy dinosaurs next to a row of blocks or linking cubes. Count how many blocks tall or long each dinosaur is. Record findings with simple marks or stickers. <i>EYLF: LO4.3, LO4.1</i>
Creative Play	• Speculative Dinosaur Design – Provide natural materials (sticks, stones, fabric scraps) and art supplies. Children create their own dinosaur using shapes and textures of their choice. Talk about what features they chose (long neck, spiky back, big tail). <i>EYLF: LO5.3, LO4.1</i>
Dramatic Play	• Dinosaur Family Line-Up – Provide adult and baby dinosaur toys. Children arrange them in order from smallest to biggest and act out family routines (biggest protects, smallest hides). <i>EYLF: LO1.3, LO4.1</i> • Shape Body Play – Children use their bodies to make different shapes (circle, triangle, rectangle) and pretend to be different dinosaurs. <i>EYLF: LO3.2, LO4.1</i>
Communication and Language	• Dinosaur Sizes Books – Share books that show different sized animals during group times. Books remain accessible for revisiting throughout the day. Educator uses simple questions like "Which dinosaur is the biggest?" or "How long is this one?" <i>EYLF: LO5.1, LO5.2</i> • Size Talk – During group time, show pictures of different sized dinosaurs. Ask children to use size words (big, small, long, short, tall) to describe them. <i>EYLF: LO5.1, LO4.1</i>

Dinosaurs – Fossils

Focus of Learning	Use this page when children are:	Next Steps / Extension Ideas:
Children explore how we learn about animals from long ago through hands-on discovery—digging, finding, and making imprints. This learning supports curiosity about the past, fine motor development through tool use, sensory exploration of textures, and early scientific thinking about evidence and discovery	• digging in sand, soil, or sensory materials • pressing objects into soft materials • asking "How do we know about dinosaurs?" or "What is a fossil?" • showing interest in bones, shells, or hidden objects • using tools like brushes, spoons, or tweezers	

Domain	Activity Ideas
Sensory and Nature Play	• Dinosaur Dig – Fill a shallow tray with sand, soil, or kinetic sand. Bury toy dinosaur bones, shells, or stones. Provide small brushes, spoons, or tweezers. Children dig and uncover the hidden objects. Educator supports language like "What did you find?" and "How did it get buried?" <i>EYLF: LO3.1, LO4.2</i> • Fossil Imprint Tray – Provide play dough, clay, or soft mud. Children press natural materials (leaves, shells, twigs, toy dinosaur feet) into the dough to make imprints. Compare the different shapes and patterns. <i>EYLF: LO3.1, LO5.3</i> • Baking Soda Clay Fossils – Mix baking soda and water to form a soft clay. Children are invited to press natural materials or toy dinosaur parts into the clay. Leave to air-dry and display the "fossils." <i>EYLF: LO4.1, LO5.3</i>
Dramatic Play	• Palaeontologist Role Play – Provide small brushes, magnifying glasses (toy), and buckets. Children pretend to be scientists finding bones in the sandpit or garden. Educator supports language like "You found a fossil!" and "What do you think it is?" <i>EYLF: LO1.2, LO4.1</i> • Fossil Museum – Set up a display table with found objects (shells, stones, imprints). Children arrange the items and show them to others. Talk about what each "fossil" tells us. <i>EYLF: LO1.3, LO5.1</i>
Creative Play	• Fossil Rubbing – Place leaves, shells, or textured items under paper. Children rub crayons over the paper to reveal the shapes. Talk about how the patterns look like fossils. <i>EYLF: LO5.3, LO4.1</i> • Clay Bone Making – Provide clay or dough. Children shape their own "bones" or "teeth" and leave them to dry. Compare the different shapes and sizes. <i>EYLF: LO5.3, LO4.1</i>
Motor Skills	• Brush and Dust – Provide small brushes and trays with sand or soil. Children use the brushes to gently uncover hidden objects. Practise fine motor control and patience. <i>EYLF: LO3.2, LO4.1</i> • Tweezer Pick-Up – Provide tweezers and small objects (shells, stones, toy bones). Children pick up the objects and place them in containers. <i>EYLF: LO3.2, LO4.1</i>
Cognitive Play	• Match the Imprint – Provide play dough imprints and the objects that made them (shell, leaf, twig). Children match the imprint to the object. <i>EYLF: LO4.1, LO4.2</i> • Count the Finds – After digging, children count how many objects they found. Record with simple marks or stickers. <i>EYLF: LO4.3, LO4.1</i>



Construction – Building & Structures

Focus of Learning	Use this page when children are:	Next Steps / Extension Ideas:
Children explore how materials stack, balance, and connect through hands-on manipulation. This learning supports spatial awareness, cause-and-effect understanding (gravity), and gross motor development through lifting, carrying, and placing.	- Stacking blocks high and knocking them down - Trying to balance objects on top of each other - Carrying large or heavy materials from one place to another - Asking "Why did it fall?" or "How do I make it taller?" - Showing interest in how things stay up or fall over	

Domain	Activity Ideas
Motor Skills	The Big Lift – Provide large, lightweight cardboard boxes, foam blocks, or empty plastic crates. Children work individually or in pairs to lift, carry, and stack these large items to build a "wall" or "tower." Focus on safe lifting techniques and body awareness. <i>EYLF: LO3.2, LO4.1</i> Balance Beam Bridge – Lay a low beam or a line of flat planks on the floor. Children walk across it to "deliver" a block to the other side, then return for another. This integrates balance with the purpose of construction. <i>EYLF: LO3.2, LO4.3</i> Stack and Crash – Provide a mix of soft (foam) and hard (wood) blocks. Children build a tower as high as they can, then are invited to push it over. Discuss the sound, the speed of the fall, and the feeling of the blocks hitting the floor. <i>EYLF: LO3.2, LO4.1</i>
Sensory and Nature Play	Mud Brick Builders – Provide wet soil, water, and simple moulds (or just hands). Children press mud into shapes to make "bricks," let them dry slightly, and then stack them. Discuss the change in texture from wet/sticky to hard/dry. <i>EYLF: LO3.1, LO4.2</i> Natural Stackers – Collect flat stones, smooth logs, and sticks from the outdoor area. Children try to balance these irregular shapes on top of each other. This requires more precision than uniform blocks and introduces the concept of "wobbly" vs. "stable." <i>EYLF: LO4.1, LO2.4</i> Sandcastle Foundations – In the sandpit, children dig a deep hole and build a wall around it using wet sand and buckets. They explore how wet sand holds shape while dry sand falls apart. <i>EYLF: LO3.1, LO4.2</i>
Dramatic Play	The Builder's Vest – Provide oversized hard hats, high-vis vests, and toy tools (plastic hammers, wrenches). Children put on the gear and "work" on their block structures, using simple language like "I am building a house" or "Fixing the wall." <i>EYLF: LO1.3, LO2.1</i> Fort or Cave – Drape large sheets or blankets over a structure of chairs and blocks. Children crawl inside to create a "secret base" or "fort," transforming the construction into a functional space for play. <i>EYLF: LO1.3, LO4.1</i>
Creative Play	Block Printing – Dip the ends of large blocks in washable paint and press them onto long strips of paper. Children create patterns or "walls" of colour, connecting the physical act of building with mark-making. <i>EYLF: LO5.3, LO4.1</i> Cardboard City – Provide large cardboard boxes of various sizes. Children decorate them with crayons or stickers and then stack them to create a "city" or "town" for their toy cars. <i>EYLF: LO4.1, LO5.3</i>

Construction – Tools & Materials

Focus of Learning	Use this page when children are:	Next Steps / Extension Ideas:
Children explore how tools work and how different materials feel through hands-on manipulation. This learning supports fine motor development, hand-eye coordination, and sensory discrimination as they twist, bang, scoop, and feel.	• showing interest in real or toy tools (hammers, screwdrivers, tongs) • trying to twist, bang, or screw things together • exploring different textures • pretending to fix or build things • asking "What does this do?" or "How does this work?"	

Domain	Activity Ideas
Motor Skills	• Hammering Station – Provide a stable surface (tree stump, soft wood, or foam block) and child-safe hammers with golf tees or similar. Children hammer the tees into the surface, focusing on grip, aim, and force. Close supervision required. <i>EYLF: LO3.2, LO4.1</i> • Nuts and Bolts Twist – Provide large metal or plastic nuts and bolts. Children match the nut to the bolt and twist them together. This strengthens wrist rotation and finger muscles. <i>EYLF: LO3.2, LO4.1</i> • Tongs and Scoops – Provide child-sized tongs, scoops, and a bin of loose materials (pom-poms, large beads, or gravel). Children use the tools to transfer materials from one container to another. <i>EYLF: LO3.2, LO4.2</i>
Sensory and Nature Play	• Tool Box Treasure Basket – Fill a low basket with safe, real hardware items (metal washers, short pipes, wooden dowels, smooth stones, fabric scraps). Children are invited to sit and explore the items, feeling the weight, temperature, and texture of each. <i>EYLF: LO3.1, LO5.1</i> • Wood and Metal Feel – Provide offcuts of different woods (rough bark, smooth pine) and metals (cool aluminium, heavier steel). Children touch and compare the temperatures and textures. Talk about "rough," "smooth," "cold," and "warm." <i>EYLF: LO3.1, LO4.1</i> • Natural Tool Making – Provide a selection of natural materials found on Country (smooth stones, sturdy sticks, bark strips, and dried grass). Invite children to explore how these materials can be used as tools: using a flat stone to "grind" leaves, a stick to "dig" in the sand, or bark to "wrap" a bundle. Educators can shares that Aboriginal and Torres Strait Islander peoples have used these natural materials to make tools for thousands of years, long before metal or plastic. <i>EYLF: LO2.4, LO3.1</i>
Dramatic Play	• The Workshop – Set up a low workbench or table. Provide toy tools (drills, saws, wrenches) and safe "construction materials" (cardboard tubes, boxes). Children wear hard hats and pretend to fix or build, mimicking the actions they observed in the hammering activity. <i>EYLF: LO1.3, LO2.1</i> • Fix-It Shop – Provide "broken" items (toys with removable parts, boxes with lids). Children use toy screwdrivers or wrenches to "fix" them, focusing on the action of turning and fitting. <i>EYLF: LO1.3, LO4.1</i>
Communication and Language	• Tool Talk – During group time, introduce one tool at a time. Name it ("This is a hammer") and demonstrate the action ("We bang with it"). Children repeat the word and mimic the action. <i>EYLF: LO5.1, LO3.2</i> • Book: Tool Box – Share Tool Box by Anne Rockwell or a similar simple board book about tools. Point to the pictures and ask children to find the matching real tool. <i>EYLF: LO5.1, LO5.2</i>

Construction – Roads, Bridges & Pathways

Focus of Learning	Use this page when children are:	Next Steps / Extension Ideas:
Children explore how to connect spaces and move along paths through hands-on building and movement. This learning supports spatial awareness, balance, and understanding of how pathways are created and used for travel.	• lining up blocks, planks, or loose parts in a row • driving toy vehicles along a path or track • walking on lines, narrow surfaces, or bridges • showing interest in how things connect (road to house, bridge over water) • talking about "going somewhere" or "where does this lead?"	

Domain	Activity Ideas
Motor Skills	• Pathway Walk – Tape a line on the floor or lay down planks. Children walk along the path, trying not to fall off. Vary the width (wide for beginners, narrow for challenge). Talk about "straight," "curvy," and "bridge." EYLF: LO3.2, LO4.3 • Vehicle Delivery Run – Provide toy trucks and a marked path (tape or blocks). Children drive the vehicles along the path, stopping at "delivery points" (marked spots). Focus on steering and staying on the path. EYLF: LO3.2, LO4.1
Sensory and Nature Play	• Natural Pathways – Collect sticks, stones, bark, and leaves from the outdoor area. Children lay these materials on the ground to create a path. Talk about how Aboriginal people walked on these natural paths on Country for thousands of years, using the land as it was. EYLF: LO2.4, LO3.1 • Sand Road Building – In the sandpit, children use their hands or tools to dig long channels for "roads." Add toy cars to drive along them. Explore how wet sand holds shape while dry sand falls apart. EYLF: LO3.1, LO4.2 • Texture Trail – Create a path with different surfaces (grass mat, sand tray, smooth fabric, bubble wrap). Children are invited to walk barefoot and talk about how each surface feels under their feet. EYLF: LO3.1, LO5.1
Dramatic Play	• Car Journey – Set up a "road" with tape or blocks. Children drive toy cars along the path, stopping at "traffic lights" (red/green cards) or "bus stops" (marked spots). EYLF: LO1.3, LO5.1 • Builder & Driver Roles – Provide hard hats and toy vehicles. Children take turns being the "builder" (making the road) and the "driver" (using the road). Switch roles to explore both perspectives. EYLF: LO1.3, LO2.1
Creative Play	• Road Painting – Provide large paper and toy cars with paint on their wheels. Children drive the cars across the paper to make roads. Compare different patterns (straight, curvy, zigzag). EYLF: LO5.3, LO4.2 • Block Roads – Provide long blocks or planks. Children lay them down to make a road for their toy cars. Challenge: "Can you make a road that goes all the way across the room?" EYLF: LO4.1, LO5.3

Construction – Machines & Vehicles

Focus of Learning	Use this page when children are:	Next Steps / Extension Ideas:
Children explore how machines move and carry things through hands-on play. This learning supports gross motor skills, understanding of force (push/pull), and early engineering concepts through observation and imitation.	• showing interest in trucks, diggers, or construction vehicles • pushing or pulling heavy objects • making machine sounds (vroom, beep, dig) • pretending to drive or operate vehicles • asking "What does that machine do?" or "How does it move?"	

Domain	Activity Ideas
Motor Skills	• Push and Pull – Provide wagons, trucks, or ride-on toys. Children push them loaded with blocks or pull them empty. Talk about "heavy" and "light," "fast" and "slow." <i>EYLF: LO3.2, LO4.1</i> • Lift and Carry – Provide large, lightweight blocks or boxes. Children lift them and carry them to a "construction site." Focus on safe lifting and body awareness. <i>EYLF: LO3.2, LO4.1</i>
Sensory and Nature Play	• Dump Truck Play – Fill a sensory bin with sand or soil. Provide dump trucks. Children fill the trucks and dump the sand. Explore how the sand flows and piles up. <i>EYLF: LO3.1, LO4.2</i> • Guess the Machine – Play recordings of construction sounds. Children listen and guess which machine is making the sound. Provide picture cards of each machine for them to point to or match. Talk about what clues helped them guess. <i>EYLF: LO5.1, LO3.2</i> • Material Movement – Provide vehicles and loose materials (pebbles, leaves, fabric). Children use the vehicles to move the materials from one place to another, or are invited to build piles for vehicle to drive over. Observe children use materials. <i>EYLF: LO3.1, LO4.1</i>
Dramatic Play	• Construction Site – Set up a space with toy diggers, trucks, and cones. Children act as operators, driving and moving materials. Provide hard hats and vests for role-play. <i>EYLF: LO1.3, LO2.1</i> • Machine Stories – Children create simple stories involving machines working together (e.g., "The digger digs, the truck carries, the builder builds"). Use toy figures to act out the sequence. <i>EYLF: LO1.3, LO5.1</i>
Creative Play	• Vehicle Track Art – Dip toy vehicle wheels in washable paint and roll them across large paper. Compare different track patterns from different vehicles (truck vs. digger). <i>EYLF: LO5.3, LO4.2</i> • Machine Design – Provide cardboard boxes, tubes, and fabric. Children create their own "machine" by decorating the box and adding moving parts (e.g., a lever, a wheel). <i>EYLF: LO4.1, LO5.3</i>
Communication and Language	• Book: <i>Goodnight, Goodnight, Construction Site</i> – Share <i>Goodnight, Goodnight, Construction Site</i> by Sherri Duskey Rinker. The rhythmic text and clear illustrations of machines are perfect for toddlers to follow and mimic. <i>EYLF: LO5.1, LO5.2</i>

Construction – Demolition & Rebuilding

Focus of Learning	Use this page when children are:	Next Steps / Extension Ideas:
Children explore cause and effect through the cycle of building, knocking down, and starting again. This learning supports emotional regulation, resilience, and understanding of gravity and force through joyful, repetitive play.	• building towers and immediately knocking them down • laughing or cheering when structures fall • saying "again!" after something crashes • experimenting with different ways to knock things down (push, throw, kick) • rebuilding in the same spot or a new one	

Domain	Activity Ideas
Motor Skills	• Crash and Rebuild – Provide large foam blocks or cardboard boxes. Children build a tower, then knock it down with their hands or a soft ball. Immediately encourage them to build again. Talk about "up" and "down," "crash" and "again." <i>EYLF: LO3.2, LO4.1</i> • Ball Bowling – Set up a wall of blocks or empty plastic bottles. Children roll a soft ball to knock them down. Count how many fall, then set them up again. <i>EYLF: LO3.2, LO4.2</i> • Demolition Swing – Hang a soft object (fabric ball, cushion) from a string. Children swing it to knock down a tower of blocks. Focus on the cause-and-effect of the swing. <i>EYLF: LO3.2, LO4.1</i>
Sensory and Nature Play	• Soft Block Crash – Provide soft foam blocks or cushions. Children build and crash if safe. <i>EYLF: LO3.1, LO4.1</i> • Sand Castle Knock-Down – In the sandpit, children build sandcastles with buckets and moulds. They stomp or sweep them flat, then build again. Talk about how sand changes shape. <i>EYLF: LO3.1, LO4.2</i> • Natural Material Demolition – Provide sticks, bark, and leaves. Children are invited to build small structures and knock them down. Notice how natural materials scatter differently than blocks. <i>EYLF: LO3.1, LO2.4</i>
Dramatic Play	• Controlled Demolition – Build a tower together. Children take turns pulling out one block at a time to see if it stays up or falls. Count how many pulls before the crash. <i>EYLF: LO1.3, LO4.2</i>
Cognitive Play	• Predict the Crash – Before knocking down a tower, ask children: "Will it fall to the left or right?" or "Will it make a loud or soft sound?" Test their predictions and discuss what happened. <i>EYLF: LO4.1, LO4.2</i> • Build Higher Each Time – Challenge children to build a tower, knock it down, then rebuild it taller. Count how many blocks they add each time. <i>EYLF: LO4.1, LO4.3</i>
Communication and Language	• Crash Talk – During group time, use words to describe the demolition: "crash," "bang," "fall," "tumble," "scatter," "rebuild." Children act out the words with their bodies. <i>EYLF: LO5.1, LO3.2</i> • Book: The Three Little Pigs – Share The Three Little Pigs (various versions). The story naturally includes building, knocking down, and rebuilding stronger. Children can act out the wolf blowing down the houses. <i>EYLF: LO5.1, LO5.2</i>

Construction – Houses & Shelters

Focus of Learning	Use this page when children are:	Next Steps / Extension Ideas:
Children explore how spaces are built to provide safety, comfort, and home. This learning supports spatial awareness, storytelling, and understanding of how different materials create different kinds of shelters, linking construction to the concept of "home" and belonging.	• building structures that look like houses, forts, or caves • pretending to live inside a structure they've built • asking "Who lives here?" • bringing dolls or figures into their builds • talking about their own home or family	

Domain	Activity Ideas
Dramatic Play	• Build a Fort – Drape large sheets, blankets, or fabric over chairs, tables, or a frame of blocks. Children can assist with the build. Provide pillows and soft toys to make it comfortable cave or forte. <i>EYLF: LO1.3, LO4.1</i> • Dollhouse Construction – Provide large cardboard boxes, tape, and fabric. Children create rooms or floors for their dolls or stuffed animals. They can add "doors" (cutouts) and "windows" (drawn or taped). <i>EYLF: LO1.3, LO5.1</i> • Animal Shelters – Provide natural materials (sticks, leaves, bark) and toy animals. Children build small shelters for the animals (a nest for a bird, a burrow for a rabbit). Talk about what the animal needs to stay safe. <i>EYLF: LO1.3, LO2.1</i>
Motor Skills	• Wall Building – Provide large, lightweight blocks or cardboard boxes. Children stack them to create walls for a house. Focus on stability and making the walls high enough to stand inside. <i>EYLF: LO3.2, LO4.1</i> • Roof Placement – Provide flat planks, cardboard, or fabric. Children carefully place these on top of their walls to create a roof. This requires balance and coordination. <i>EYLF: LO3.2, LO4.1</i> • Doorway Creation – Provide arch-shaped blocks or two vertical blocks with a horizontal one on top. Children create doorways to walk through. Talk about "big enough for me" or "small for the dog." <i>EYLF: LO3.2, LO4.1</i>
Sensory and Nature Play	• Mud Hut Building – Provide wet soil, water, and straw (or shredded paper). Children mix "mud" and press it into shapes to build small huts. Let them dry slightly to see how the material hardens. <i>EYLF: LO3.1, LO4.2</i> • Leaf Roofing – Collect large leaves, bark, and grass. Children layer these over a frame of sticks to create a thatched roof. Discuss how these materials keep rain out. <i>EYLF: LO3.1, LO2.4</i> • Sand Home – In the sandpit, children dig a hole and build walls around it using wet sand and buckets. They can create a "basement" or "underground home." <i>EYLF: LO3.1, LO4.2</i>
Creative Play	• House Decoration – Provide paper, crayons, and stickers. Children decorate the outside of their cardboard box houses or draw pictures to hang on the "walls." <i>EYLF: LO5.3, LO4.1</i> • Blueprint Drawing – Provide large paper and crayons. Children draw a simple plan of their house before building it (e.g., "Here is the door, here is the bed"). <i>EYLF: LO5.3, LO4.1</i>

Light & Colour

Water & Flow

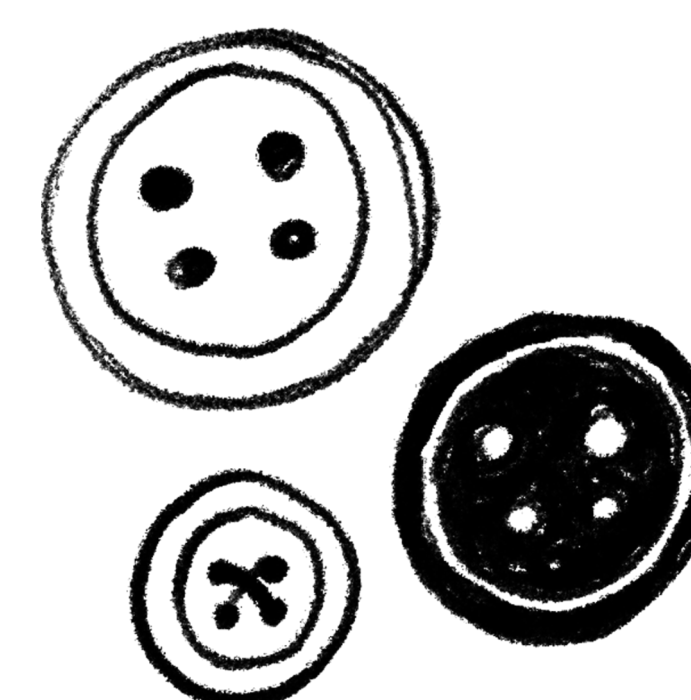
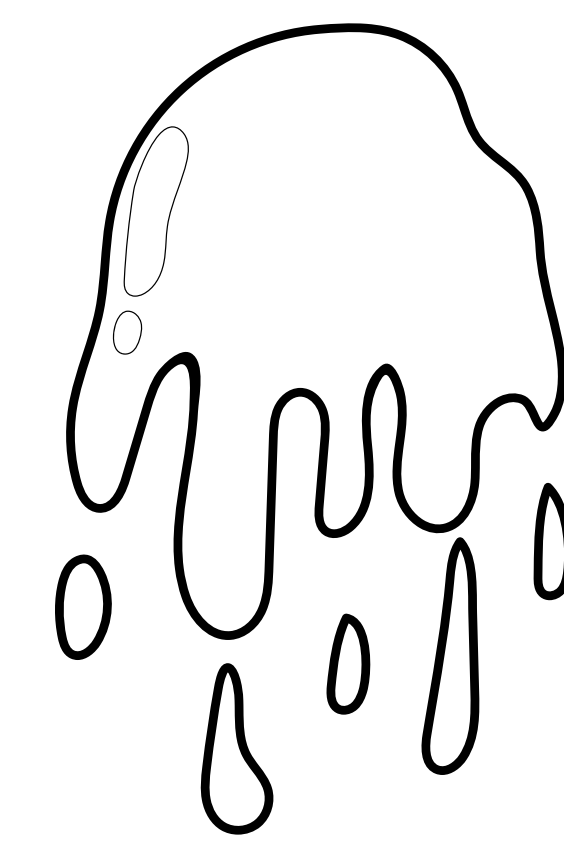
Sound &
Listening

Messy Play

Movement &
Balance

Textures &
Touch

Sensory Play



Sensory – Water & Flow

Focus of Learning	Use this page when children are:	Next Steps / Extension Ideas:
Children explore the properties of water through pouring, splashing, and observing how objects move through it. This learning supports sensory regulation, early physics concepts (sink/float), and understanding of water as a precious resource on Country.	• pouring water from one container to another • dropping objects into water and watching them sink or float • splashing or playing with water flow • asking "Why did it sink?" or "Where did the water go?" • showing calm or focused attention during water play	

Domain	Activity Ideas
Sensory and Nature Play	• Pouring Station – Provide shallow trays, jugs, cups, and funnels. Children pour water between containers, observing how it flows, spills, and fills. Use different-sized containers to explore volume. <i>EYLF: LO3.1, LO4.2</i> • Sink and Float Tray – Fill a shallow tray with water. Provide natural materials (leaves, stones, bark) and recycled items (corks, plastic lids). Children test what stays up and what goes down. Talk about "heavy" and "light," "float" and "sink." <i>EYLF: LO3.1, LO4.2</i> • Waterholes on Country – Fill a shallow tray with water and add natural materials (stones, bark, leaves). Children explore the "waterhole" and talk about how Aboriginal people have cared for water sources on Country for thousands of years. Water is sacred and essential for all living things. <i>EYLF: LO2.4, LO3.1</i>
Motor Skills	• Scoop and Transfer – Provide large spoons, tongs, or sponges. Children scoop water from one container to another, practising hand-eye coordination and grip strength. <i>EYLF: LO3.2, LO4.1</i> • Splash and Move – In a safe outdoor area, provide cups or watering cans. Children pour water onto the ground, observing how it spreads and soaks in. Focus on the movement of their arms and the flow of water. <i>EYLF: LO3.2, LO4.1</i>
Dramatic Play	• Wash the Toys – Provide a basin of water, soap (optional), and toy animals or dolls. Children "wash" the toys, mimicking real-life routines. Talk about keeping things clean and caring for belongings. <i>EYLF: LO1.3, LO2.1</i>
Creative Play	• Water Painting – Provide large brushes and buckets of water. Children "paint" on the ground, fences, or large paper. The water disappears as it dries, creating a temporary artwork. <i>EYLF: LO5.3, LO4.1</i> • Colour Mixing – Add food colouring to water in clear containers. Children pour different colours together and observe how they mix (e.g., blue + yellow = green). <i>EYLF: LO5.3, LO4.1</i>
Cognitive Play	• Predict the Sink – Before dropping an object into water, ask children: "Will it sink or float?" Test their predictions and discuss what happened. <i>EYLF: LO4.1, LO4.2</i> • Measure the Water – Provide measuring cups and a large container. Children fill the container and count how many cups it takes to fill it. <i>EYLF: LO4.3, LO4.1</i>

Sensory– Messy Play

Focus of Learning	Use this page when children are:	Next Steps / Extension Ideas:
Children explore textures, mixtures, and materials through hands-on, open-ended play. This learning supports sensory regulation, creativity, and understanding of how materials change when combined, while connecting to traditional uses of natural materials on Country.	• squishing, squeezing, or manipulating soft materials • mixing different substances together (water + dirt, paint + sand) • showing curiosity about how materials feel • engaging in calm, focused exploration with their hands	

Domain	Activity Ideas
Sensory and Nature Play	• Mud Kitchen – Provide bowls, spoons, cups, and real dirt or soil. Children mix "recipes" (mud pies, potions) and explore how wet and dry materials feel different. Talk about "sticky," "crumbly," and "smooth." <i>EYLF: LO3.1, LO4.2</i> • Natural Playdough – Provide homemade playdough (flour, salt, water, oil) with natural additives (cinnamon, lavender, food colouring). Children knead, roll, and shape the dough. Discuss the smell and texture. <i>EYLF: LO3.1, LO4.1</i> • Ochre Painting – Provide natural clay or ochre powder mixed with water to create paint. Children use sticks, leaves, or brushes to paint on paper or bark. Educator shares that Aboriginal people have used ochre for thousands of years for art, ceremony, and marking Country. <i>EYLF: LO2.4, LO5.3</i> • Gloop or Slime – Provide cornflour and water to make "oobleck" (non-toxic slime). Children squeeze it through their fingers and observe how it changes from solid to liquid. <i>EYLF: LO3.1, LO4.2</i>
Motor Skills	• Squeeze and Squish – Provide sponges soaked in water or soft dough. Children squeeze, wring, and manipulate the materials, building hand strength and coordination. <i>EYLF: LO3.2, LO4.1</i> • Mix and Stir – Provide bowls and spoons. Children mix ingredients (flour + water, paint + sand) and observe how the texture changes. Focus on the circular motion of stirring. <i>EYLF: LO3.2, LO4.1</i>
Dramatic Play	• Cooking Station – Provide pots, pans, and "ingredients" (mud, sand, water, leaves). Children pretend to cook meals and serve them. <i>EYLF: LO1.3, LO5.1</i> • Artist Studio – Provide aprons, brushes, and natural paints (ochre, berry juice, clay). Children create artwork and display it on a "gallery wall." <i>EYLF: LO1.3, LO5.3</i>
Creative Play	• Finger Painting – Provide thick, washable paint and large paper. Children use their fingers to create marks, patterns, and pictures. Discuss the colours and shapes they make. <i>EYLF: LO5.3, LO4.1</i> • Texture Collage – Provide glue and various materials (sand, leaves, fabric scraps, rice). Children stick materials onto paper to create textured artwork. <i>EYLF: LO5.3, LO4.1</i>

Sensory – Textures & Touch

Focus of Learning	Use this page when children are:	Next Steps / Extension Ideas:
Children explore the world through tactile discrimination, distinguishing between different textures, temperatures, and weights. This learning supports sensory processing, vocabulary development, and the ability to describe physical properties, while connecting to the natural materials used by Aboriginal people for tools and art	• touching and describing materials • sorting objects by texture or feel • showing interest in natural materials • asking "What is this?" or "How does it feel?" • closing their eyes to guess what they are touching	

Domain	Activity Ideas
Sensory and Nature Play	• Texture Sorting Tray – Provide a collection of natural and recycled materials (smooth stones, rough bark, soft fabric, prickly pinecones, cool metal washers). Children are invited to sort them into "rough" and "smooth" or "soft" and "hard" groups. <i>EYLF: LO3.1, LO4.1</i> • Feel Box Mystery – Place various objects inside a box with a hole cut for hands. Children reach in, feel an object, and guess what it is before pulling it out. Encourage descriptions like "It's bumpy" or "It's cold." <i>EYLF: LO3.1, LO5.1</i> • Natural Material Exploration – Provide a basket of items found on Country (sticks, leaves, shells, feathers, smooth river stones). Children explore the textures and discuss how Aboriginal people used these materials to make tools, shelters, and art. <i>EYLF: LO2.4, LO3.1</i> • Temperature Match – Provide materials that feel different temperatures (cool metal, warm wood, cold ice pack wrapped in cloth, room-temperature fabric). Children match items that feel "hot," "cold," or "warm." <i>EYLF: LO3.1, LO4.1</i>
Motor Skills	• Fine Motor Pinch – Provide small items (beads, buttons, seeds) and tweezers or tongs. Children pick up items and sort them into containers, strengthening finger muscles needed for writing. <i>EYLF: LO3.2, LO4.1</i> • Texture Rubbing – Place textured items (leaves, bark, coins) under paper. Children rub crayons over the paper to reveal the pattern. Focus on the pressure needed to feel the texture. <i>EYLF: LO3.2, LO4.1</i>
Dramatic Play	• Fabric Shop – Provide swatches of different fabrics (velvet, denim, silk, wool). Children explore the patterns and textures of the fabrics and can pretend to sell them or make clothes. <i>EYLF: LO1.3, LO4.1</i>
Creative Play	• Texture Collage – Provide glue and various textured materials (sand, rice, fabric scraps, leaves). Children stick them onto paper to create a tactile artwork. <i>EYLF: LO5.3, LO4.1</i> • Sculpting with Clay – Provide air-dry clay or playdough. Children mold shapes and explore textures. After some time of playing with plain playdough, natural materials can be added to extend interest and notice the different textures. <i>EYLF: LO5.3, LO4.1</i>
Cognitive Play	• Match the Pair – Provide pairs of identical textured items (two pieces of sandpaper, two soft cloths). Children close their eyes (or not), feel one, and find its match. <i>EYLF: LO4.1, LO4.2</i> • Texture Hunt – Give children a "texture map" (pictures of rough, smooth, soft). They walk around the room to find objects that match each picture. <i>EYLF: LO4.1, LO5.1</i>

Sensory – Movement & Balance

Focus of Learning	Use this page when children are:	Next Steps / Extension Ideas:
Children explore their bodies in space through movement, balance, and coordination. This learning supports the vestibular (balance) and proprioceptive (body awareness) systems, which are critical for self-regulation, spatial awareness, and confidence in physical play, while connecting to traditional ways of moving across Country.	• climbing, jumping, spinning, or rolling • trying to balance on one foot or a narrow surface • seeking "heavy work" (pushing, pulling, carrying) • showing excitement or calm after vigorous movement • asking "How far can I jump?" or "Can I walk on this?"	

Domain	Activity Ideas
Motor Skills	• Balance Beam Walk – Lay a line of tape, a low beam, or a row of flat stones on the ground. Children walk across if safe. Vary the challenge (wide path for beginners, narrow for advanced). Talk about "steady," "slow," and "careful." <i>EYLF: LO3.2, LO4.3</i> • Animal Movements – Invite children to move like different animals: "stomp like an elephant," "creep like a snake," "hop like a frog," "fly like a bird." This explores different body positions and muscle groups. <i>EYLF: LO3.2, LO5.1</i> • Moving on Country – Create a path with natural obstacles (logs to step over, stones to balance on, grass to walk through). Children navigate the path, learning that Aboriginal people have moved across this land for thousands of years. <i>EYLF: LO2.4, LO3.2</i>
Sensory and Nature Play	• Spin and Stop – Children spin around slowly (safely) and then stop on command. Discuss how their body feels (dizzy, steady) and how they regain balance. <i>EYLF: LO3.2, LO4.1</i> • Rolling Down a Hill – If safe, find a gentle grassy slope. Children roll down (head to toe or side to side) and notice the sensation of movement and gravity. <i>EYLF: LO3.2, LO4.1</i> • Nature Obstacle Course – Set up a course using natural materials: step over sticks, walk on flat stones, crawl under branches. Children navigate the course, using their whole bodies to overcome challenges. <i>EYLF: LO3.2, LO4.3</i>
Dramatic Play	• Tracker Role Play – Provide hats and "binoculars" (cardboard tubes). Children pretend to be trackers, moving quietly through the "bush" (classroom or outdoor area) to find hidden objects. Talk about moving "slowly" and "carefully" like Aboriginal trackers. <i>EYLF: LO1.3, LO2.4</i> • Dance of the Land – Play music with different rhythms. Children move their bodies to match the beat (fast, slow, strong, gentle). Discuss how movement can tell a story about the land. <i>EYLF: LO3.2, LO5.1</i>
Cognitive Play	• Follow the Leader – One child leads a movement (e.g., "hop on one foot"), and others follow. This requires observation and imitation. <i>EYLF: LO4.1, LO3.2</i> • Stop and Go – Play music. When it plays, children move; when it stops, they freeze. This builds impulse control and body awareness. <i>EYLF: LO3.2, LO1.3</i>

Sensory – Sound & Listening

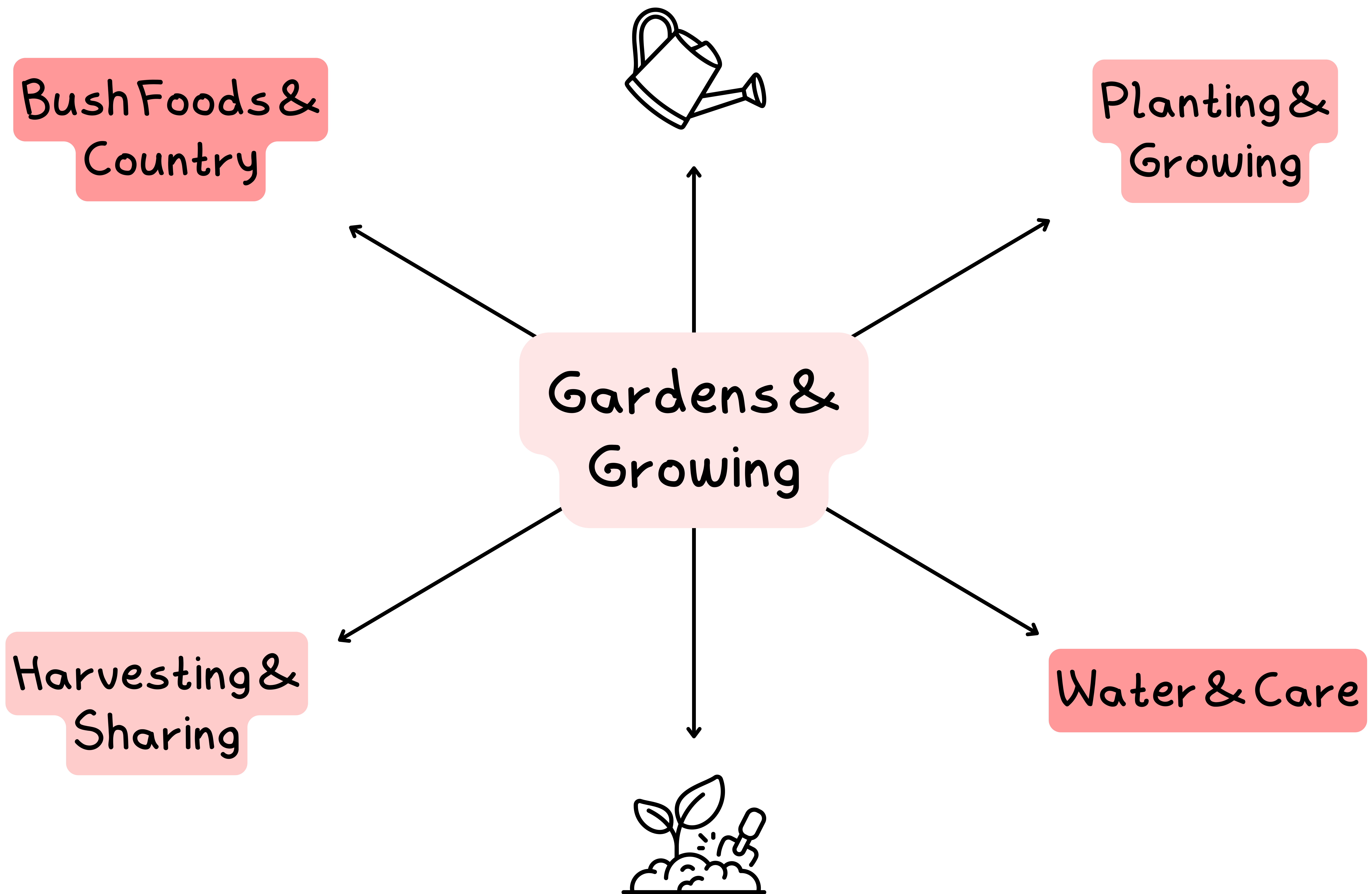
Focus of Learning	Use this page when children are:	Next Steps / Extension Ideas:
Children explore how sound travels, how to identify different sounds, and how to listen carefully to their environment. This learning supports auditory processing, attention skills, and the ability to discriminate between different frequencies and volumes, while connecting to the traditional practice of "listening to Country."	• making sounds with their mouths, hands, or objects • asking "What was that noise?" or "Where did that sound come from?" • showing interest in musical instruments or sound-making toys • closing their eyes to listen more carefully	

Domain	Activity Ideas
Sensory and Nature Play	• Sound Matching – Provide pairs of identical sound-makers (shakers, bells, drums). Children shake one and find its matching sound. Start with obvious differences (loud/soft) and progress to subtle ones. <i>EYLF: LO3.1, LO4.1</i> • Listen to Country – Play recordings of natural sounds from Country (birds, wind, water, insects). Children close their eyes and identify what they hear. Explore ideas that Aboriginal people have always listened to these sounds to understand Country. <i>EYLF: LO2.4, LO3.1</i> • Sound Hunt – Take children outside or around the room. Ask them to listen for specific sounds (birds, cars, footsteps, wind). Mark each sound on a checklist when they hear it. <i>EYLF: LO3.1, LO5.1</i> • Volume Control – Provide instruments (drums, shakers, bells). Children practice making "loud" and "soft" sounds, and learn to control their volume based on cues (e.g., "quiet like a mouse," "loud like a lion"). <i>EYLF: LO3.1, LO3.2</i>
Motor Skills	• Rhythm Clapping – Play simple rhythms on a drum. Children clap along, copying the pattern. Start with slow, steady beats and progress to faster, more complex patterns. <i>EYLF: LO3.2, LO4.1</i> • Sound and Move – Play music with different tempos. Children move their bodies to match (slow for calm music, fast for upbeat music). This connects auditory input to physical response. <i>EYLF: LO3.2, LO5.1</i>
Dramatic Play	• Radio Station – Provide a toy microphone and "broadcasting" equipment. Children pretend to be radio hosts, making sounds and speaking into the mic. Talk about "on air," "volume," and "listening." <i>EYLF: LO1.3, LO5.1</i> • Animal Sounds – Provide pictures of animals. Children make the corresponding sounds and match them to the pictures. Discuss how different animals make different noises. <i>EYLF: LO1.3, LO5.1</i>
Creative Play	• Instrument Making – Provide materials (rice in bottles, rubber bands on boxes, shells on strings). Children create their own instruments and explore the sounds they make. <i>EYLF: LO5.3, LO4.1</i>
Cognitive Play	• Guess the Sound – Play recordings of common sounds (doorbell, car horn, animal, water). Children guess what is making the sound. Start with obvious sounds and progress to more subtle ones. <i>EYLF: LO4.1, LO5.1</i>

Sensory – Light & Colour

Focus of Learning	Use this page when children are:	Next Steps / Extension Ideas:
Children explore how light and colour interact through observation, experimentation, and creative play. This learning supports visual processing, understanding of cause-and-effect, and appreciation of the natural colours found on Country.	• noticing shadows or reflections • pointing to colours and naming them • showing interest in light sources (windows, lamps, torches) • asking "Why is it dark?" or "What colour is this?" • mixing paints or watching colours change	

Domain	Activity Ideas
Sensory and Nature Play	• Light Table Exploration – Provide a light table or a clear container with a torch underneath. Add translucent materials (coloured plastic shapes, cellophane, water beads). Children place materials on the surface and observe how light passes through. Talk about "bright," "see-through," and "glowing." <i>EYLF: LO3.1, LO4.1</i> • Shadow Play – In a dimmed room, shine a torch or lamp onto a wall. Children use their hands or toys to create shadows. Talk about "big shadow," "small shadow," and "moving shadow." <i>EYLF: LO3.1, LO4.2</i> • Colours of Country – Provide natural materials in ochre colours (red dirt, yellow sand, white clay, brown bark, green leaves). Children sort them by colour and discuss how Aboriginal people have used these colours from the land for thousands of years for art and ceremony. <i>EYLF: LO2.4, LO3.1</i> • Colour Mixing Water – Provide clear containers with water and food colouring (red, blue, yellow). Children pour colours together and observe how they change (red + yellow = orange). Talk about "new colour" and "mixing." <i>EYLF: LO3.1, LO4.2</i>
Motor Skills	• Flashlight Chase – In a dimmed room, shine a flashlight on the floor. Children try to "catch" the light with their feet or hands. This builds visual tracking and gross motor coordination. <i>EYLF: LO3.2, LO4.1</i> • Colour Run – Place coloured mats or fabric around the room. Call out a colour, and children run to stand on that colour. This combines movement with colour recognition. <i>EYLF: LO3.2, LO4.1</i>
Dramatic Play	• Shadow Puppet Theatre – Hang a white sheet or use a blank wall and shine a torch behind it. Children use their hands, cut-out shapes, or toys to create shadows on the screen. They can act out simple stories or just explore how moving their hands changes the shadow's size and shape. Talk about "big shadow," "small shadow," and "moving shadow." <i>EYLF: LO1.3, LO5.1</i>
Creative Play	• Texture Collage – Provide glue and various textured materials (sand, rice, fabric scraps, leaves). Children stick them onto paper to create a tactile artwork. <i>EYLF: LO5.3, LO4.1</i>
Cognitive Play	• Colour Sort – Provide a mix of coloured objects (blocks, pom-poms, fabric). Children sort them into containers by colour. Start with two colours, then increase difficulty. <i>EYLF: LO4.1, LO4.2</i> • Light and Dark – Provide two boxes: one with a torch inside (light) and one closed (dark). Children explore the difference and talk about "I can see" vs. "I can't see." <i>EYLF: LO4.1, LO4.2</i>



Gardens & Growing – Planting & Growing

Focus of Learning	Use this page when children are:	Next Steps / Extension Ideas:
Children explore how plants grow from seeds through hands-on planting, watering, and observing change over time. This learning supports understanding of cause-and-effect, patience, and connection to the natural world, while recognising that Aboriginal people have cultivated plants on Country for thousands of years.	• showing interest in dirt, mud, or soil • digging holes in the ground or sandpit • noticing plants, flowers, or leaves outdoors • asking "How does it grow?" or "What's inside the seed?" • watching things change over time (sprouting, getting bigger)	

Domain	Activity Ideas
Sensory and Nature Play	• Dig and Plant – Provide a garden bed, large pot, or shallow tray with soil. Offer child-sized trowels, seeds (beans, sunflowers, or fast-sprouting herbs), and watering cans. Children plant the seeds assisted by Educators and care for them over time. <i>EYLF: LO3.1, LO4.2</i> • Sprouting Jar – Place a wet paper towel and a few beans in a clear jar. Children observe the seeds each day and notice the root and shoot emerging. Talk about "growing," "changing," and "getting bigger." <i>EYLF: LO3.1, LO4.2</i> • Native Planting – Plant native edible plants (lemon myrtle, native mint, or murnong/yam daisy if available). Talk about how Aboriginal people have grown and gathered these plants on Country for thousands of years, knowing when to plant and harvest by the seasons. <i>EYLF: LO2.4, LO3.1</i>
Motor Skills	• Scoop and Fill – Provide small pots, scoops, and soil. Children fill pots with soil using scoops, practising hand-eye coordination and grip strength. <i>EYLF: LO3.2, LO4.1</i> • Watering Can Carry – Provide small watering cans filled with a small amount of water. Children carry them to the plants and pour carefully. Focus on balance and controlled movement. <i>EYLF: LO3.2, LO4.1</i>
Dramatic Play	• Gardener Role Play – Provide hats, gloves, and toy tools. Children pretend to be gardeners, "planting" toy vegetables or flowers in a pretend garden (soil tray or sandpit). <i>EYLF: LO1.3, LO4.1</i>
Communication and Language	• Planting Books – Share books that show how seeds grow into plants during group times. Books remain accessible for revisiting throughout the day. Educator uses simple questions like "What does a seed need to grow?" or "What happened to the seed?" <i>EYLF: LO5.1, LO5.2</i> ◦ Suggested book examples: <i>The Tiny Seed (Eric Carle)</i>, <i>Peggy (Anna Walker)</i>, <i>All Through the Year (Jane Godwin and Anna Walker)</i>, <i>Big Red Kangaroo (Claire Saxby)</i>
Creative Play	• Natural Materials Collage – Provide glue, paper, and natural materials (leaves, petals, small twigs, grass, bark pieces). Children stick materials onto paper to create patterns or pictures of plants. Talk about where each material came from and how it feels. <i>EYLF: LO5.3, LO4.1</i> • Plant Painting – Provide large paper and green paint. Children use their hands or brushes to paint "stems" and "leaves," creating their own plant artwork. <i>EYLF: LO5.3, LO4.1</i>

Gardens & Growing – Water & Care

Focus of Learning	Use this page when children are:	Next Steps / Extension Ideas:
Children explore how water helps plants grow through hands-on watering, observing changes, and understanding the needs of living things. This learning supports sensory regulation, responsibility, and early scientific thinking about cause-and-effect, while connecting to how Aboriginal people have always cared for water sources on Country.	• carrying watering cans or buckets • noticing if plants look dry or wilted • asking "Do the plants need a drink?" or "Where does the water go?" • enjoying the feeling of wet soil or splashing water • watching water soak into the ground or evaporate	

Domain	Activity Ideas
Sensory and Nature Play	• Watering the Garden – Provide small watering cans with a small amount of water. Children water their planted seeds or established plants. Talk about "gentle," "enough," and how much water plants need. <i>EYLF: LO3.1, LO2.1</i> • Wet vs. Dry Soil – Provide two trays: one with dry soil, one with wet soil. Children touch and compare the textures. Talk about how dry soil feels compared to the dry. <i>EYLF: LO3.1, LO4.1</i> • Water Absorption Exploration – Provide a tray with a variety of absorbent materials (sponges, cotton wool, paper towels, leaves, bark) and a bowl of water. Invite children to dip the materials, observe how they change, and which ones hold the most water or dry fastest. <i>EYLF: LO3.1</i> • Water on Country – Talk about how Aboriginal people have always known where to find water on Country (billabongs, waterholes, springs) and how they cared for these sources so plants and animals could survive. If possible, observe a local water source. <i>EYLF: LO2.4, LO3.1</i>
Motor Skills	• Pour and Carry – Provide small pitchers or cups. Children pour water from one container to another, practising hand-eye coordination and controlled movement. <i>EYLF: LO3.2, LO4.1</i>
Creative Play	• Water Painting – Provide large brushes and buckets of water. Children "paint" the ground or a fence, watching the water disappear as it soaks in or evaporates. <i>EYLF: LO5.3, LO4.1</i> • Wet Art – Provide wet sponges (or other absorbent mediums) and dry paper. Children press the sponges onto the paper to create water marks. Talk about how the paper changes when wet. <i>EYLF: LO5.3, LO4.1</i>
Communication and Language	• Water Talk – During group time, use words to describe water and care: "water," "drink," "thirsty," "wet," "dry," "soak," "pour," "care." Children act out the words. <i>EYLF: LO5.1, LO3.2</i> • Planting Books – Share books that show how water helps plants grow during group times. Books remain accessible for revisiting throughout the day. Educator uses simple questions like "What does the plant need?" or "How does the water help?" <i>EYLF: LO5.1, LO5.2</i> ◦ Suggested book examples: <i>The Tiny Seed</i> (Eric Carle), <i>Peggy</i> (Anna Walker), <i>All Through the Year</i> (Jane Godwin and Anna Walker), <i>Big Red Kangaroo</i> (Claire Saxby)

Gardens & Growing – Harvesting & Sharing

Focus of Learning	Use this page when children are:	Next Steps / Extension Ideas:
Children explore how water helps plants grow through hands-on watering, observing changes, and understanding the needs of living things. This learning supports sensory regulation, responsibility, and early scientific thinking about cause-and-effect, while connecting to how Aboriginal people have always cared for water sources on Country.	• carrying watering cans or buckets • noticing if plants look dry or wilted • asking "Do the plants need a drink?" or "Where does the water go?" • enjoying the feeling of wet soil or splashing water • watching water soak into the ground or evaporate	

Domain	Activity Ideas
Sensory and Nature Play	• Garden Gathering – Provide small baskets or buckets. Children walk through the garden and collect fallen leaves, flowers, or safe vegetables (if growing). Talk about "finding," "picking," and "gathering." <i>EYLF: LO3.1, LO2.1</i> • Basket of Treasures – Fill a basket with natural materials (leaves, flowers, seed pods, feathers). Children explore the textures and decide which items to give to a friend or place in a shared bowl. Talk about "giving" and "sharing." <i>EYLF: LO3.1, LO1.3</i> • Harvest Sensory Tray – Provide a shallow tray with soil, toy vegetables, and small baskets. Children "harvest" the vegetables by digging them out and placing them in baskets. Talk about "finding," "pulling," and "collecting." <i>EYLF: LO3.1, LO4.1</i> • Sharing on Country – Talk about how Aboriginal people have always shared what they gathered (bush foods, tools, knowledge) with their community. Provide a large basket and invite children to place their gathered items inside. <i>EYLF: LO2.4, LO1.3</i>
Dramatic Play	• Market Stall – Set up a simple stall with baskets, toy vegetables, and fabric bags. Children take turns being the "seller" and the "shopper," exchanging items. Talk about "giving," "taking," and "thank you." <i>EYLF: LO1.3, LO5.1</i>
Creative Play	• Harvest Collage – Provide glue, paper, and natural materials (leaves, petals, seed pods). Children stick them onto paper to create a "harvest picture." Talk about what they gathered and where it came from. <i>EYLF: LO5.3, LO4.1</i> • Basket Weaving – Provide strips of fabric or thick yarn and a simple frame. Children weave the materials in and out to create a "basket" for gathering. <i>EYLF: LO5.3, LO4.1</i>
Cognitive Play	• Sort the Harvest – Provide a mix of toy vegetables or natural materials. Children sort them by type, size, or colour into different baskets. <i>EYLF: LO4.1, LO4.2</i>
Communication and Language	• Harvest Books – Share books that show gathering and sharing during group times. Books remain accessible for revisiting throughout the day. Educator uses simple questions like "What did they find?" or "Who are they sharing with?" <i>EYLF: LO5.1, LO5.2</i> ◦ Suggested book examples: <i>Harvest (Sarah L. Schuette), All Through the Year (Jane Godwin and Anna Walker), Big Red Kangaroo (Claire Saxby), Possum Magic (Mem Fox and Julie Vivas)</i>

Gardens & Growing – Harvesting & Sharing

Focus of Learning	Use this page when children are:	Next Steps / Extension Ideas:
Children explore native Australian plants and bush foods through sensory experiences, observation, and storytelling. This learning supports connection to Country, cultural respect, and understanding that Aboriginal people have gathered and cared for these plants for thousands of years.	• showing interest in native plants, berries, or seeds • touching, smelling, or tasting safe native materials • asking "What is this plant?" or "Can we eat this?" • listening to stories about Country and traditional foods • noticing differences between native and introduced plants	

Domain	Activity Ideas
Sensory and Nature Play	• Bush Tucker Sensory Tray – Provide a shallow tray with native materials (Lilly Pilly berries, finger lime segments, wattleseed pods, dried leaves). Children touch, smell, and observe the textures and colours. <i>EYLF: LO3.1, LO2.4</i> • Native Plant Exploration – Plant safe, edible native plants (Lilly Pilly, native rosemary, Warrigal greens) in pots or a garden bed. Children observe the leaves, flowers, and berries. Talk about how Aboriginal people have used these plants for food and medicine. <i>EYLF: LO3.1, LO2.4</i> • Seasonal Chart – Create a wall chart showing when different bush foods are in season (e.g., Lilly Pilly in summer, wattle in spring). Children add pictures or stickers as seasons change. <i>EYLF: LO3.1, LO4.2</i>
Dramatic Play	• Gatherer Role Play – Provide baskets, coolamons (wooden carrying vessels), and toy native plants. Children pretend to gather bush foods, walking carefully through the "bush" (outdoor area or classroom). Talk about "finding," "collecting," and "respecting Country." <i>EYLF: LO1.3, LO2.4</i> • Bush Food Market – Set up a simple stall with native materials (berries, leaves, seeds) and fabric bags. Children take turns being the "gatherer" and the "buyer," exchanging items. Talk about "sharing" and "trading." <i>EYLF: LO1.3, LO5.1</i>
Creative Play	• Bush Food Collage – Provide glue, paper, and native materials (dried leaves, seeds, petals). Children stick materials onto paper to create a "Country picture." Talk about where each material came from. <i>EYLF: LO5.3, LO4.1</i> • Ochre Painting – Provide natural clay or ochre powder mixed with water. Children use sticks or brushes to paint on paper or bark. Educator shares that Aboriginal people have used ochre for art and ceremony for thousands of years. <i>EYLF: LO5.3, LO2.4</i> • Leaf Rubbing – Place native leaves under paper. Children rub crayons over the paper to reveal the leaf pattern. Talk about the shape and texture of the leaf. <i>EYLF: LO3.2, LO4.1</i>
Communication and Language	• Bush Food Books – Share books that show native plants and bush foods during group times. Books remain accessible for revisiting throughout the day. Educator uses simple questions like "What is this plant?" or "How do Aboriginal people use this?" <i>EYLF: LO5.1, LO5.2</i> ◦ Suggested book examples: <i>Bush Tukka Guide for Kids</i> (Samantha Martin), <i>Napangardi's Bush Tucker Walk</i> (Lyndall Stavrou and Jann Forge), <i>Walking with the Seasons in Kakadu</i> (various), <i>Plantastic!</i> (Catherine Clowes and Rachel Gyan)

Gardens & Growing – Bonus

Domain	Activity Ideas
Sensory and Nature Play	• Bug Hotel – Provide a small wooden box, crate, or a quiet corner of the garden. Children collect dry leaves, twigs, pinecones, bark, and hollow stems. They stack and arrange the materials loosely to create "rooms" for insects. Check the hotel regularly to see who has moved in. Talk about how bugs help the garden grow. <i>EYLF: LO2.1, LO4.2</i> • Scent Walk – Plant or provide strongly scented plants (lemon myrtle, native mint, rosemary, lavender, lemon-scented gum leaves). Children walk through the garden, gently rubbing a leaf between their fingers and smelling their hands. Ask: "Does this smell like lemons? Like mint? Like sweets?" Talk about how Aboriginal people use these plants for food and medicine. <i>EYLF: LO3.1, LO5.1</i>
Motor Skills	• Wind Watchers – Help children make simple pinwheels using paper and sticks, or wind chimes using string, shells, seed pods, and sticks. Hang them in the garden. Children watch how the wind moves the pinwheels and chimes, and notice how the plants move too. Talk about "wind," "air," and "dancing leaves." <i>EYLF: LO4.2, LO3.2</i>
Cognitive Play	• The Growing Journal – Take photos of the same plant or sprouting seeds every few days. Print the photos and place them side-by-side on a large pad of paper or in a simple folder. Children look at the photos and notice the changes: "Look, it was tiny here, and now it has two leaves!" This makes the slow process of growing visible and concrete for toddlers. <i>EYLF: LO4.1, LO5.1</i> • The Rotting Box – Provide a clear plastic container with a lid (with small air holes). Children place fruit scraps, dry leaves, and soil inside. Put the lid on and place it in a sunny spot. Open it every few days to observe changes. Talk about how the scraps are turning into "new soil" that can help new plants grow. <i>EYLF: LO2.2, LO4.2</i>